



You Can
Receive

THE BAPTISM

into the **HOLY SPIRIT**

now



ZACHARIAS TANEE FOMUM

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HOW TO CONTINUE IN THE SPIRIT-FILLED LIFE

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I dedicate this book to

CELINE MBELE BIDJA

With profound gratitude for her unusual commitment to the book
ministry.



PREFACE

I was converted to Christ during my first week at the University. I faithfully grew in the Lord and was keen on winning others to the Lord. For three years, during which I witnessed to an average of three students a week, I saw three students converted to the Lord Jesus. I was however unsatisfied and wondered if there was not more to the matter of winning people to Christ than I was seeing.

Four years later on, while I was doing postgraduate work, I was praying in my room at 5 p.m., yearning for power to speak at the Christian Union in Makerere University, Kampala, Uganda. I was not expecting anything in particular, apart from the assurance that the Lord was coming with me into that meeting. I had not been praying for more than five minutes when suddenly I found myself praying loudly, actually shouting praises to God in other tongues. Many students gathered around my room to find out what was happening. I continued to speak in tongues loudly for the

next two hours.

From that day, I began to see people turn to the Lord in a remarkable way as I witnessed to them at the individual level, or as I preached to them in large numbers. Sometimes I knelt to pray and was so lost in God that I would not realize that I had been praying for five or six hours. That was fifteen years ago. I was baptized into the Holy Spirit! This book is about that experience - The Baptism into the Holy Spirit.

May God bless you as you read it. May you be baptized into the Holy Spirit as you read it, and if you are already baptized into the Holy Spirit, may the Lord lead you into a greater experience of the power of the Spirit-filled life.

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Chapter 1



THE FOUR BAPTISMS

There are four baptisms outlined for us in the Scriptures.

1. THE BAPTISM INTO THE BODY OF CHRIST

The Bible says,

“For just as the Body is one and has many members, and all the members of the body, though many, are one body, so it is with Christ. For by one Spirit we were all baptized into one body - Jews or Greeks, slaves or free - and all were made to drink of one Spirit. For the body does not consist of one member but many.” (1 Corinthians 12:12-14).

This is the first baptism that a believer undergoes. When a person believes in his heart that Jesus is Lord, he is justified before God. That means that from that moment, God considers him as one who has never sinned. This is because the righteousness of Christ is immediately imparted to him. He may not yet have raised up his hand in an evangelistic meeting. He may not yet have come forward at an altar call. He may not yet have repeated the prayer for those who want to receive

the Lord, but from the very moment when he believes in his heart that Jesus is Lord, this baptism into the Body of Christ, His church, takes place. Those who receive this baptism are children of God. The others are not. Those who receive this baptism are members of the body of Christ. Anyone who believes that he is justified, and therefore a member of the body of Christ, must receive all the other members and show them love, regardless of any areas of differences that there may exist between them. Therefore, all in the Body must love all who are in the Body.

In the baptism into the Body, the following facts stand:

1. The Baptizer: the Holy Spirit
2. The object being baptized: the one who believes in the Lord Jesus.
3. The medium into which he is baptized: the Body of Christ; the Church.

All believers have received this baptism. Those who have received this baptism have eternal life. They shall never perish. Only the Holy Spirit knows for certain those who have received this baptism from Him. We accept the testimony of people when they say to us, “I believe that Jesus Christ is Lord,” and treat them as members of the Body on the basis of their confession. Treating them on the basis of their confession means, in addition to many other things, loving them as Christ loved the Church; that is, up to the point of dying for them.

All who have believed in the Lord Jesus should know for certain that the Holy Spirit has baptized them into the Body of Christ. They should know

Him” (Romans 8:9).

The Bible says,

“Do you not know that you are God’s temple and that God’s Spirit dwells in you?” (1 Corinthians 3:16).

“Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you, which you have from God? You are not your own.” (1 Corinthians 6:19).

It is one thing to have the Holy Spirit. One receives the Holy Spirit for spiritual life and one is filled with the Holy Spirit for power for spiritual ministry.

2. THE BAPTISM INTO THE HOLY SPIRIT

The Lord Jesus said, “And behold, I send you the promise of my Father upon you; but stay in the city, until you are clothed with power from on high.” (Luke 24:49).

“On the last day of the feast, the great day, Jesus stood up and proclaimed, “If anyone thirst, let him come to me and drink. He who believes in me, as the scripture has said, ‘Out of his heart shall flow rivers of living water’.” (John 7:37-38). “And while staying with them he charged them not to depart from Jerusalem, but to wait for the promise of the Father, which, he said, “You heard from me, for John baptized with water, but before many days you shall be baptized with the Holy Spirit.” (Acts 1:4-5).

“But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you, and you shall be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria and to the end of the earth.” (Acts 1:8).

And Peter said to them, “Repent, and be baptized everyone of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins, and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.” (Acts 2:38).

“Now when the apostles at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent to them Peter and John, who came down and prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit; for it had not yet fallen on any of them, but they had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. Then they laid their hands on them and they received the Holy Spirit.” (Acts 8:14-17).

“While Peter was still saying this, the Holy Spirit fell on all who heard the word. And the believers from among the circumcised who came with Peter were amazed, because the gift of the Holy Spirit had been poured out even on the Gentiles. For they heard them speaking in tongues and extolling God. Then Peter declared, “Can anyone forbid water for baptizing these people who have received the Holy Spirit just as we have?” (Acts 10:44-47).

In the baptism of the Holy Spirit, the Holy Spirit is said to “come upon”, to “fall upon” the believer who already has the Holy Spirit as the Giver of divine life. He comes upon the believer then, not to give him life, but to give him power for service. In this ministry then, the Holy Spirit is not envisaged as “a spring of water welling up to eternal life,” (for springs

talk of origin) but as a river. The differences between a spring and a river are obvious. The Holy Spirit comes in “the baptism into the Holy Spirit” to give the endowment, the anointing, the power, for service.

In the baptism into the Holy Spirit, the following facts stand out:

1. The Baptizer: the Lord Jesus Christ
2. The object being baptized: the believer.
3. The medium into which he is baptized: the Holy Spirit.

All believers are baptized into the Body of Christ without any asking from them. All they need to do is to believe in the Lord. For the baptism into the Holy Spirit, this may be the case as it happened in the home of Cornelius and on the day of Pentecost, but in the cases of Saul of Tarsus, the Samaritan believers and the Ephesian believers, He came upon people with the laying on of hands. The Bible says,

“God exalted him at his right hand as Leader and Saviour, to give repentance to Israel and forgiveness of sins. And we are witnesses to these things, and so in the Holy Spirit whom God has given to those who obey him.” (Acts 5:31-32).

“If you then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him?” (Luke 11:13).

The minimum condition for baptism into the Holy Spirit is faith in Jesus

Christ.

For the first Pentecost, Jesus had to be exalted. For all subsequent Pentecosts, He should be exalted as Lord and Supreme Leader of the individual who wants to be baptized into the Holy Spirit.

All who have been baptized into the Holy Spirit know for certain the exact time when it happened. They do not need anyone to assure them that it has happened. They know it.

Because this book is about baptism into the Holy Spirit, things will become clearer as you read on.

3. THE BAPTISM INTO WATER

The Bible says, “Repent and be baptized everyone of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins; and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.” (Acts 2:38).

“And he said to them, ”Go into all the world and preach the gospel to the whole creation. He who believes and is baptized will be saved; but he who does not believe will be condemned.” (Mark 16:16).

“Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you; and lo, I am with you always, to the close of the age.” (Matthew 28:19-20).

In the baptism into water, the following facts stand:

1. The baptizer: a baptized believer in the Lord Jesus.
2. The object being baptized: the believer in the Lord Jesus who has not yet been baptized since he believed.
3. The medium into which he is baptized: water.

The baptism into water is not an absolute necessity for baptism into the Holy Spirit.

4. THE BAPTISM OF SUFFERING.(ALSO CALLED BY SOME, THE BAPTISM OF FIRE).

The Lord Jesus said,

“I came to cast fire upon the earth; and would that it were already kindled! I have a baptism to be baptized with; and how I am constrained until it is accomplished!” (Luke 12:49-50).

“And James and John, the sons of Zebedee, came forward to him and said to him, ”Teacher, we want you to do for us whatever we ask of you.” And he said to them, “What do you want me to do for you?” And they said to him, “Grant us to sit, one at your right hand and one at your left, in your glory.” But Jesus said to them, “You do not know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I drink, or to be baptized with the baptism with which I am baptized?” And they said to him, “We are able.” And Jesus said to them, “The cup that I drink, you will drink; and with the baptism with which I am baptized, you will be baptized; but to sit at my right hand or my left is not mine to grant, but it is for those for whom it is prepared.” (Mark

10:35-40).

In the baptism of suffering, the following facts stand:

1. The Baptizer: God the Father.
2. The object being baptized: the consecrated believer.
3. The medium into which he is baptized: suffering.

The Lord Jesus underwent this baptism. The Father smote the Shepherd.
The consecrated believer will inevitably undergo this baptism.

Chapter 2



THE ADVANTAGES OF SPEAKING IN TONGUES

We shall see in the next chapter that the evidence that someone had received the baptism into the Holy Spirit was normally that the person spoke in tongues. So he spoke in tongues as evidence that he was baptized into the Holy Spirit. The question may arise in someone's mind as to whether there are definite advantages that the one who speaks in tongues has over the one who does not. The answer is yes. We shall briefly look at some of these advantages.

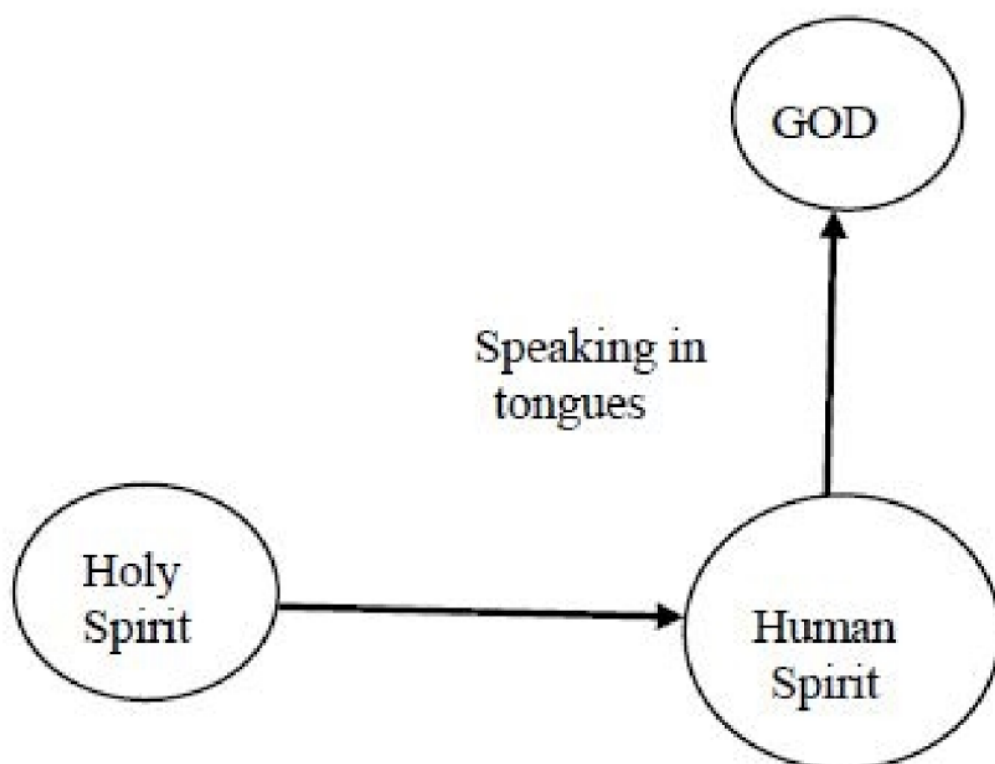
1. UTTERING MYSTERIES IN THE SPIRIT TO GOD

The Bible says,

“For one who speaks in a tongue speaks not to men but to God; for no one understands him, but he utters mysteries in the Spirit.” (1 Corinthians 14:2).

The one who speaks in tongues has an additional capacity to talk to the Lord. He utters mysteries in the Spirit to God. These mysteries originate

in the Holy Spirit. They flow into the human spirit by the action of the Holy Spirit, and as the one who speaks in tongues utters these mysteries in languages that are only understood by God, these mysteries flow to God.



They may be mysteries of praise, thanksgiving, worship, adoration, and the like, that are beyond the grasp of the human mind. By speaking in tongues and uttering these Spirit-originated and Spirit-breathed mysteries to God, man is allowed to bring to God praise, worship, adoration, that is one hundred percent of the Holy Spirit's origin. I consider it a wonderful privilege to be allowed to be involved in this.

2. PERSONAL EDIFICATION

The Bible says,

“He who speaks in a tongue edifies himself....” (1 Corinthians 14:4).

What does it mean to edify? To edify is to build up. To edify oneself is to build oneself up. The Bible commands,

“But you, beloved, build yourselves up on your most holy faith; pray in the Holy Spirit.” (Jude 20).

When a person speaks in tongues either in praise, thanksgiving, intercession, and so on, this originates in the Holy Spirit who dwells in the believer's spirit and flows through the believer's spirit, in tongues, to God. As there is this upward flow to God, the believer's spirit receives the ministry of edification. This is the indirect consequence of ministering to God in tongues. The believer who thus edifies himself is in a position to minister even more to the Lord and to others.

I find that a lot of time is wasted at meetings, to build up the believers before they can pray. This is a pity because sometimes some receive no ministry and are thereby incapable of fully participating in the prayer meeting. The same thing applies to a meeting where the word is ministered. Many need to be prepared to receive the ministry of the Word. If all believers took time to pray in tongues regularly and certainly before each meeting, the Holy Spirit who knows their peculiar needs would meet these needs, build them up and put them in the best condition for further ministry, or in a better condition to minister to others.

I find that I am able to flow more in praying with my mind after I have prayed in tongues. This must be because, somehow, my mind receives some ministry as I am praying in tongues, uttering mysteries unto God.

In fact, I find that:

1. preaching
2. teaching
3. evangelism
4. counselling
5. living
6. loving
7. caring
8. etc.,

are smoother and freer and more powerful when each is preceded by much speaking in tongues. I find other gifts of the Holy Spirit operating more freely in my life and ministry when I spend more time regularly and before each meeting in tongues.

As I write this, I wonder what would happen if I set one week or one month aside for praying in tongues. I believe that great things would happen in my life and through my life. “Lord, help me to set a season aside this year for praying in tongues. Lord, let me do it to edify myself. Let me do it so that being therefore edified, I will be in a better position to minister to You, to Your church and to Your world. Lord, help the other saints to do likewise.”

After the apostle Paul said that the one who spoke in tongues edified himself, he added,

“Now I want you all to speak in tongues.” (1 Corinthians 14:5).

He certainly saw this crucial ministry of personal edification through the speaking in tongues and its impact on the life and ministry of the believer, and so he yearned that it would be the lot of all believers. I can only join him in yearning for all believers that they would each speak in other tongues. There is also a personal yearning. He said that he spoke in tongues more than all the Corinthian believers. These believers really spoke in tongues! He, however, spoke in tongues more than all of them. Lord, enable me to so speak in tongues that my progress and capacity in that dimension will be an example for many.

We have said that the one who speaks in a tongue edifies himself. We are thereby not saying that the one who does not speak in tongues does not edify himself. He can edify himself by the other means that are open to the believer. The only problem is that the one who does not speak in tongues has one method of self- edification less than the one who speaks in tongues.

Do you want to settle for a spiritual life that has one method of self- edification less than you could have? Do you not want to have all that the Lord has made available for spiritual progress?

3. PRAYING WITH THE SPIRIT

The one who speaks in tongues has an additional channel of prayer. As

we saw, the Bible admonishes us saying,

“But you, beloved, build yourselves up on your most holy faith, pray in the Holy Spirit.” (Jude 20).

All prayer that originates in the Lord and is led and enabled by the Holy Spirit is praying in the Holy Spirit.

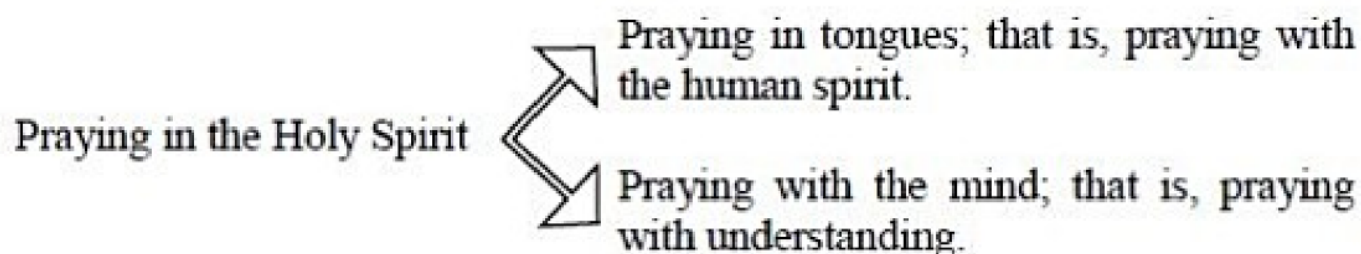
There are two types of praying that is praying in the Holy Spirit. The apostle Paul said,

“I will pray with the spirit and I will pray with the mind also.” (1 Corinthians 14:15).

It is obvious that when the apostle prayed with his mind, he was not praying in the flesh. He was praying in the Holy Spirit. The Lord Jesus prayed often with His mind. He was praying in the Holy Spirit. So, praying in the Holy Spirit includes:

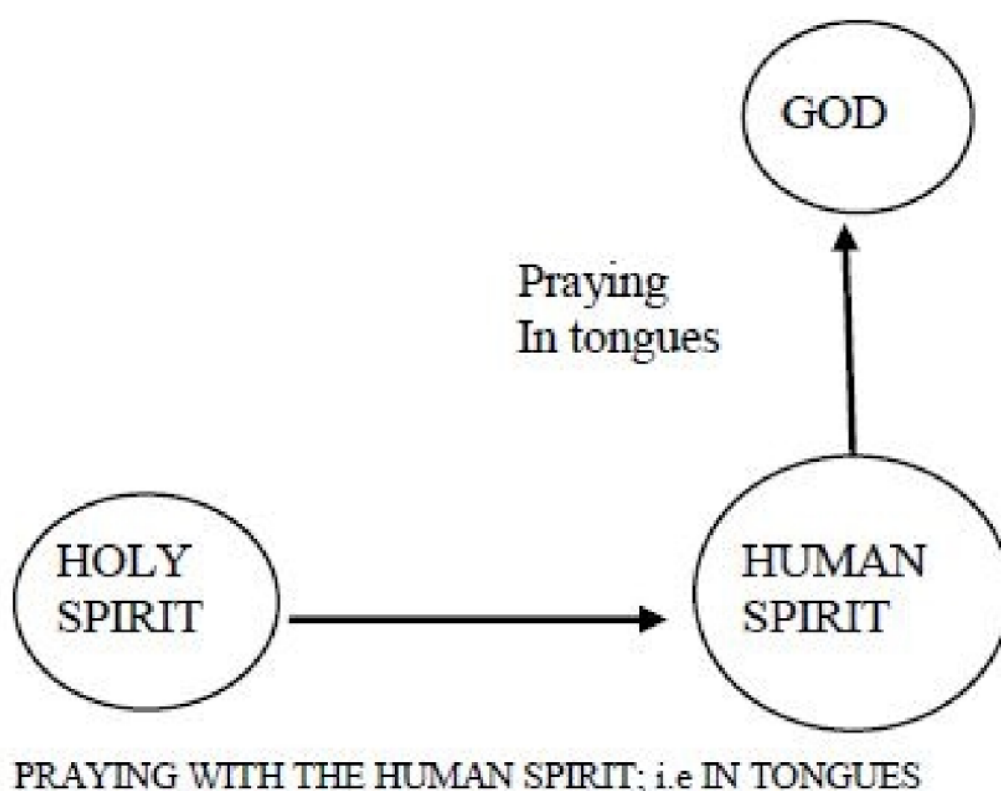
1. Praying with the human spirit: that is, praying in tongues.
2. Praying with the human mind.

The one who prays in tongues can pray with the human spirit and with the human mind whereas the one who cannot pray in tongues can pray only with the human mind.

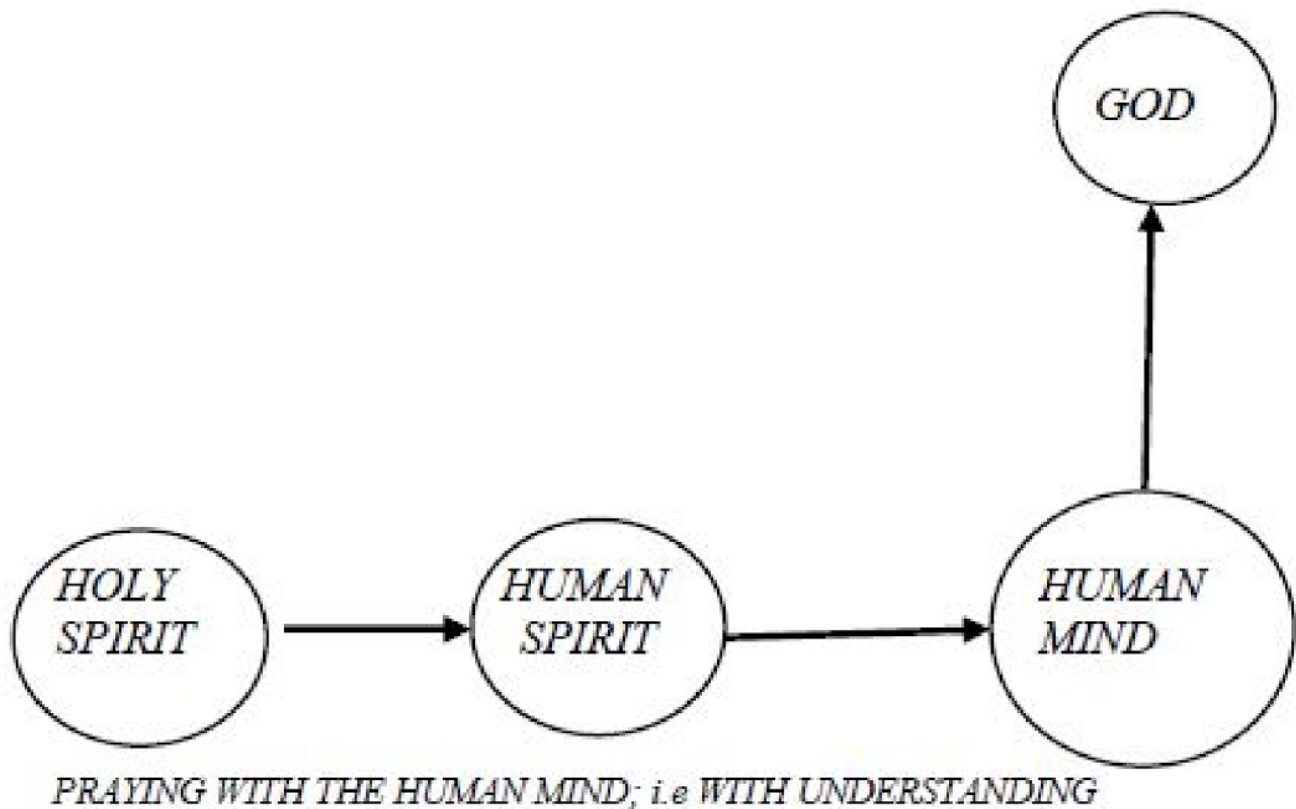


Praying with the mind; that is, praying with understanding.

We can illustrate these two “types of praying” as follows:



The prayer originates in the Holy Spirit and it is communicated to the human spirit which then prays it in tongues to God. The only limitation is how much of what the Holy Spirit has can be received by the human spirit for onward communication to God in tongues.



The prayer again originates in the Holy Spirit; for that is where all true prayer has its origin. The prayer is then communicated with the human mind through the human spirit. He does not enter into direct contact with the human mind). There is limitation as the human spirit receives only a part of what the Holy Spirit has to communicate. What the human spirit receives is again limited by what the mind is able to receive, and even this is limited by the mind's capacity to translate what it has received into words.

Praying with the mind has many limitations. For example, the one who has a limited capacity to understand can only pray to a limited extent if he prays with the mind. What he does not understand, he cannot say to God.

Praying with the spirit has the added advantage that one can pray things through that one does not understand. There are times when a person may feel in his spirit that someone is having a problem. He may not understand what the problem is, but if he is sensitive to the burden on his spirit, he will withdraw. The Holy Spirit, who has all the details and who communicated the burden to the human spirit, will cause the human spirit to pray in tongues and in this way the Lord will work and take away the problem that the person was having. Because someone, without knowing what was happening, withdrew and prayed in the spirit, people have been saved from accidents, thieves, robbers and numerous disasters. Some preachers have suddenly received a fresh upsurge of spiritual power at a point, when the meeting was getting out of hand, and so on. There is no limit to the amount of good that can be done when someone who is sensitive to the Holy Spirit receives the signal and without understanding the facts in his mind sets out to pray in tongues.

There are times when a believer may not know the will of God. The Holy Spirit always knows the will of God. He puts that will into the believer's spirit and enables him to pray it to God. That is why many great things happen when believers pray in tongues, consistently and with insistence.

Although there are many advantages that come with praying in tongues; it would be foolish to put aside praying with the mind completely. The apostle Paul says, *“For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays but my mind is unfruitful”* (1 Corinthians 14:14).

It is not God's will that our minds should become permanently unfruitful as far as prayer is concerned. The one who does not pray with his mind

will get into serious trouble. Praying with the spirit is not meant to replace praying with the mind, but to complement it. The apostle Paul said, “*I will pray with the spirit and I will pray with the mind also.*” (1 Corinthians 14:15). It is not a matter of either or, but of both.

For the purpose of illustration, I want to consider praying in tongues as walking God-wards with my spirit. If I move by jumping on my right leg, I can cover a certain distance, but I will be slow and soon get tired. I also consider my left leg as praying with my mind: with my understanding. If I jump God-wards on my left leg, I will also get somewhere, but I will again be slow and soon get tired. If I want to make the most possible progress God-wards in prayer, I must use my right and left legs. That is why the apostle said, “What am I to do?” Then he answered, “I will pray with the spirit and I will pray with the mind also.” That is God’s way. We should walk in it. The problem is that both ways are opened to the one who speaks in tongues whereas the one who does not has only one route opened to him.

I often find that when two people pray together, they can make more progress than when they pray singly. This, of course, demands a fair amount of spiritual compatibility. When a person prays with the spirit and with the mind, he gets almost as far as two people get when they pray together. First of all, the spirit and the mind are those of the same person and therefore there is compatibility. Secondly, the spirit and the mind can pray in turn so that when the mind is tired, the spirit can pray while the mind takes a rest. In this way, a person can pray for many hours alone and not be too exhausted.

Of course, there are times when even fifteen minutes of prayer in tongues will take away so much energy that it is impossible to continue, but that is for very special combative situations.

4. SINGING WITH THE SPIRIT

We all sing to the Lord with our minds. We use human books or we sing from memory. This is good. The only problem is that for those who do not speak in tongues, this is all the singing that they can do; that which passes through the mind. However, for he who speaks in tongues, he can develop his praying in tongues to include singing in tongues. He can then, like the apostle Paul, sing with his spirit and also sing with his mind. (1 Corinthians 14:15).

All believers who speak in tongues should sing in tongues too. All that is needed to sing in tongues is the same faith that is needed to pray in tongues. If you co-operate with the Holy Spirit and launch out by faith. He will give you utterance to sing melodies in tongues unto the Lord, and as you grow in the use of your spirit as an instrument of singing to the Lord, you will get to the place where you can sing with your mind and immediately turn to your spirit and sing with your spirit and again turn to your mind and so on and so forth.

5. MINISTERING TO THE SAINTS

The Bible says, *“What then, brethren? When you come together, each one has a hymn, a lesson, a revelation, a tongue, or an interpretation. Let all things be done for edification.”* (1 Corinthians 14:26).

The apostle is suggesting that believers should bring the following with

them when they assemble:

1. a hymn with the mind
2. a lesson
3. a hymn with the spirit
4. a revelation
5. a tongue
6. an interpretation of a tongue.

All these are to be brought and used for the edification of the body. The person who speaks in tongues and has also asked and received the power to interpret can, bring all the six things listed above to the body, or he can bring any of the six as the Spirit leads him and the need demands. The person who cannot speak in tongues often cannot interpret tongues. He can therefore bring to the assembly only the following:

1. a hymn with the mind
2. a revelation (this too is rare for people who are not baptized into the Holy Spirit).
3. a lesson.

I have sadly found that in too many assemblies, all that the people bring to the assembly is songs with the mind and a lesson. It is ministering

with two out of the six possibilities that the Lord has made available to us. This is a great pity, for it says that such assemblies are using one-third of the potential that the Lord has given them.

Something that is even sadder is that in many assemblies where people are baptized into the Holy Spirit and speak with other tongues, people are so closed to spiritual manifestations that they stick to the hymns with the mind and the lessons and nothing else is manifested. This ought not to be so.

Finally, I have also been to assemblies where there were so many tongues, prophecies, interpretations of tongues and revelations that no one took any of them to heart. In these assemblies there was often no lesson with real spiritual content and all singing with the mind was limited to a few short choruses which were repeated over and over. This too is sub-normal.

We should each be baptized into the Holy Spirit and speak with other tongues and bring to the assemblies the above six items and any others that the Lord may want to add. Then there will be true and complete edification.

6. SPEAKING IN TONGUES WITH INTERPRETATION

The Word of God exhorts the person who speaks in tongues to Pray for the power to interpret (1 Corinthians 14:13). When a person who speaks in tongues asks and receives from the Holy Spirit the power to interpret tongues, his own speaking in tongues takes on new importance.

First of all, he will be able to understand what he is praying in tongues. It will no longer be a matter of him praying with his spirit while his mind remains unfruitful, but of his mind coming along with his spirit as he prays.

Personally, one thing that I have benefited from the power to interpret the speaking in tongues in my private praying is that as I start to pray in tongues and then interpret, I know with my mind the direction in which my spirit is moving. I then orientate my praying with the mind to the same direction in which the Holy Spirit, through my spirit, is leading and thereby bringing deep harmony. I have in this way often been led into new dimensions and directions in prayer that I did not know before. May the Lord receive the praise for this.

When a person speaks in tongues and interprets at a public meeting, he is thus ministering at the same level with prophecy. So the person who speaks in tongues and interprets brings to the people of God something that has the same usefulness as prophecy. Obviously, the person who does not speak in tongues cannot function in this capacity.

Another blessing is that the one who speaks in tongues in a public meeting while another translates is bringing to the people of God a gift that opens the door for the ministry of another, for he will speak in tongues and another person will interpret and so the body is able to receive ministry from two people instead of from one person.

7. SPEAKING IN TONGUES LEADS TO DEEP PEACE

The Bible says, *“Nay, but by men of strange lips and with an alien*

tongue the Lord will speak to this people, to whom he has said, "This is rest to the weary and this is repose; "Yet they would not hear" (Isaiah 28:11-12).

The Lord intended to give rest to His people through the speaking in other tongues. It is also true that speaking in tongues leads to very deep inner peace for the one who has been pouring out himself to God in this way. After praise, thanksgiving, importunity and violent intercession in tongues, there is a period that follows during which all of the inner being enters into and experiences total integration. It is as if the human spirit, after pouring itself to God, falls back and rests deeply in the Holy Spirit. This is only possible after battling in tongues, for is it not normal that conflict is followed by rest?

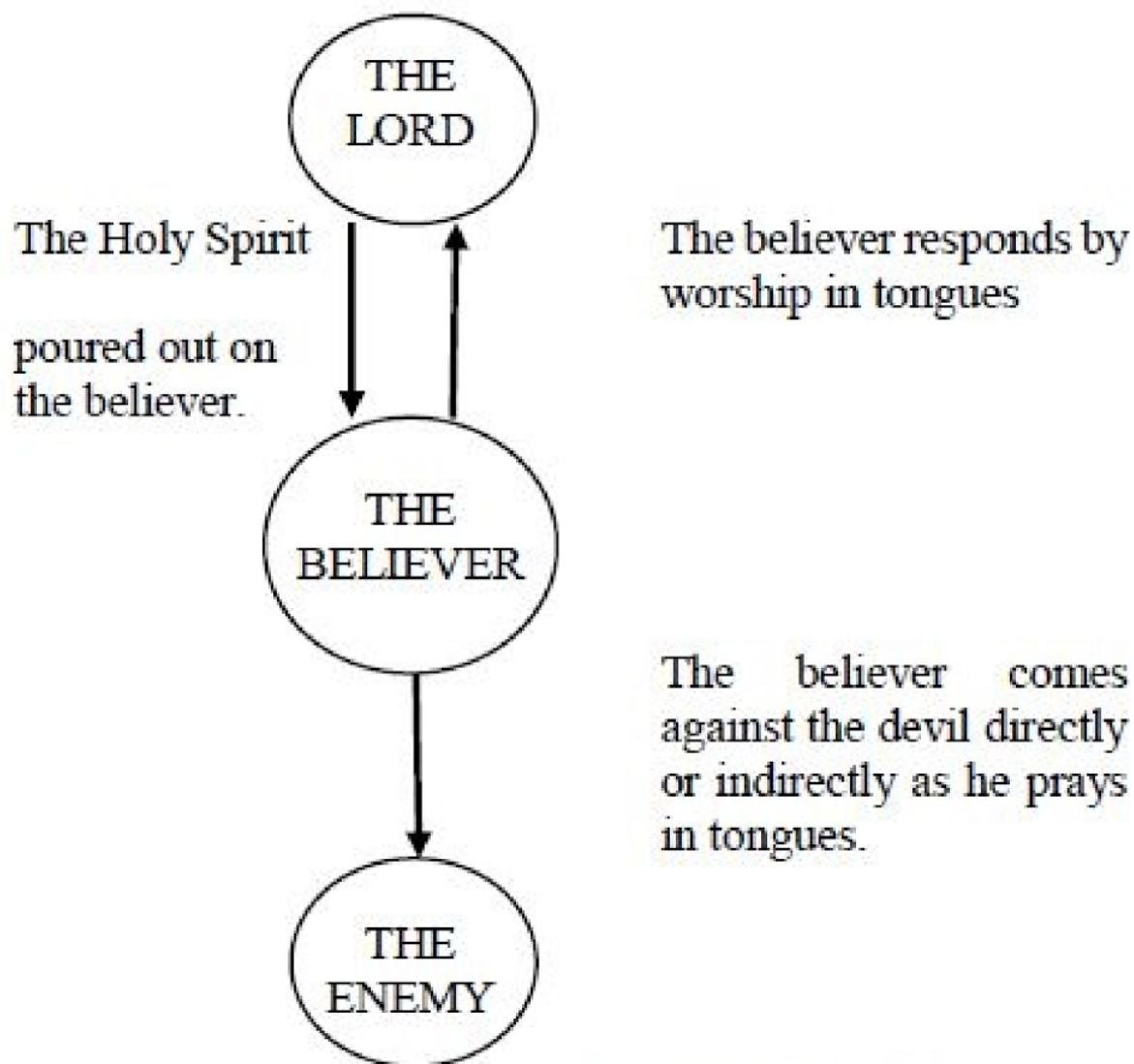
8. SPEAKING IN TONGUES AS A WEAPON IN MINISTRY.

The Bible lists five signs that will follow those who believe in Mark 16:17-18. The five are:

- Casting out demons in the name of Jesus
- Speaking in new tongues
- Picking up serpents
- Being unhurt if a deadly thing is drunk
- Laying hands on the sick and they recovering.

It is obvious that signs 1, 3, 4 and 5 are directed against the activity of

the enemy. They are for spiritual warfare. If that is so, and it is obvious that it is so, then the 2nd one, the speaking in other tongues must also have a function as a weapon in spiritual warfare. The Spirit-filled person has much of the enemy to confront. The Bible says of the Lord Jesus : *“And Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit returned from the Jordan, and was led by the Spirit for forty days in the wilderness, tempted by the devil.”* (Luke 4:1-2). As someone rightly put it, “After the dove, the devil.” The Spirit-filled person is therefore opened to so much confrontation with Satan that he has to use his gift of tongues for warfare. So he is filled with tongues to flow forth to God in praise and to flow out to the enemy in rebuke and destruction.



SPEAKING IN TONGUES : THE BELIEVER, THE LORD AND THE ENEMY.

In my ministry, I have found that during the casting out of some demons, there was resistance to deliverance in the name of Jesus until I spoke to the demons in tongues. Then there was immediate deliverance. In fact, much of my deliverance ministry has been a combination of speaking to the demons in English and in tongues.

I also found that there have been times during the ministry of the baptism into the Holy Spirit when the Spirit only came upon the person when I laid my hands on him and prayed in other tongues. Sometimes I have had

to rebuke interfering evil spirits in tongues before the person who was receiving ministry could be filled with the Holy Spirit and speak with other tongues.

THE DANGERS OF INGRATITUDE.

I have met many believers who speak in tongues, but confess the fact that they do not receive any spiritual blessings from the speaking in tongues, and that it has all become cold routine so much so that they ask themselves if there is not more to the baptism into the Holy Spirit than the speaking in tongues. True, there is more to the baptism into the Holy Spirit than the speaking in tongues. But I am worried about these people. I think they have a real problem that is deeper and has nothing to do with the speaking in other tongues. It is a problem that I have had. I was saved at the age of 21 during my first week at the University. I laboured hard in evangelism and, the next year for the first time, I led another student to whom I had been witnessing for a long time to the Lord. After I left his room where he had just received the Lord, I was so filled with joy that I was walking as if in the clouds. For the next three days I was so happy that I had no desire for food. I was full. I prayed for my spiritual child at least once every hour. I went to see him thrice every day. I was anxious that he should come to the fellowship, had his quiet time, and grow. I prayed and prayed and as I laboured on his spiritual progress, stopped many times to thank the Lord for his salvation and for the wondrous privilege that He had given me by using me to bring him to Him, I also continued to be filled with joy about what God had done. With time, I began to see individuals and then small groups and one day I saw 969 people turn to Christ after I preached one evangelisation message. As

more people responded to the gospel of Christ preached through me, I began to take things increasingly for granted until it became normal to see people turn to the Lord in evangelistic meetings. I was less joyful when I saw them make the all-important decision. I prayed less for them and I laboured less to ensure that they continued in the Lord. I was less thankful to the Lord for each one of them and I remember one evening when I gave the Lord only a formal "Thank you, Lord, for those who believed this evening". With this lack of gratitude also came the disappearance of the joy of seeing the lost saved. I own up to the same thing with regard to deliverance from demons. The first time that I delivered someone who had a demon, I was filled with gratitude to the Lord and my joy was immense. But as I have seen many people delivered, I have lost that sense of wonder and thanksgiving to the Lord. This is horrible. I confess that the same thing applies to the baptism into the Holy Spirit. When for the first time I laid my hands on someone and prayed for him to receive the baptism into the Holy Spirit and the brother immediately started speaking in other tongues, I was excited and full of praises to the Lord. Three weeks ago, when 85 people were baptized into the Holy Spirit and spoke in tongues for the first time in one evening, I was not as full of praise to God as I had been before. I was beginning to take it for granted that it should happen. I repent very sincerely of this ingratitude, this taking God for granted. Lord, forgive me for taking Your wonderful miracles of salvation, deliverance from demons in Jesus' name, and the baptism into the Holy Spirit for granted. Forgive me that instead of being increasingly grateful that You have chosen to use me on a wider scale, I have taken Your power for granted. Lord, I repent. I will take time regularly to thank You for every manifestation of Your power

through me. Thank you, Lord, for forgiving me. Amen.”

I believe that those who do not take time each day to thank the Lord for the privilege of speaking in other tongues, who do not use the gift with constant gratitude; who belittle the gift because many other believers manifest it, who say it is one of the least gifts, who give the impression that they would be just as alright without it as they are with it, will soon find it boring. Their problems stem from ingratitude, and since they do not see it fit to thank the Lord for the gift of tongues that they already have, He does not bother to hear their cries for other Spiritual gifts that they are craving for. What guarantee is there that any other gift that the Lord may give will be gratefully used?

Repent today of your ingratitude for the gift of tongues. Thank the Lord daily for it. Treat it as the honoured treasure that it is, and you will be blessed in your total being.

Chapter 3

SPEAKING IN TONGUES AS THE OBVIOUS EVIDENCE OF THE BAPTISM INTO THE HOLY SPIRIT

1. THE PROMISE OF THE LORD IN THE OLD TESTAMENT

The Lord said, *“Nay, but by men of strange lips and with an alien tongue the Lord will speak to this people, to whom he has said, ”This is rest, give rest to the weary; and this is repose; yet they would not hear.”* (Isaiah 28:11-12).

The Lord promised to talk by men of strange lips and with an alien tongue. The strange lips and alien tongue is the speaking in other tongues. This is further indicated by the fact that what was to be said was not immediately understandable. The prophet said, *“Therefore the word of the Lord will be to them: precept upon precept, precept upon precept, line upon line, line upon line, here a little, there a little; that they may go, and fall backward, and be broken, and snared, and taken.”* (Isaiah 28:13).

2. THE PROMISE OF THE LORD JESUS IN THE NEW TESTAMENT

The Lord Jesus said to them, *“Go into all the world and preach the gospel to the whole creation. He who believes and is baptized will be saved, but he who does not believe will be condemned. And these signs will accompany those who believe: in my name they will cast out demons; they will speak with new tongues; they will pick up serpents, and if they drink any deadly thing, it will not hurt them; they will lay their hands on the sick, and they will recover.”* So the Lord Jesus, after he had spoken to them, was taken up into heaven, and sat down at the right hand of God. And they went forth and preached everywhere, while the Lord worked with them and confirmed the message by the signs that attended it. Amen.” (Mark 16:15-20).

The Lord promised and He expects that the following five signs (miracles) will follow those who believe in Him:

1. In His name they will cast out demons.
2. They will speak in new tongues.
3. They will pick up serpents.
4. If they drink any deadly thing, it will not hurt them.
5. They will lay their hands on the sick and they will recover.

The first sign, that of casting out demons in the name of Jesus can only be applicable when a believer meets someone who has demons or is possessed by demons. If such a person or such persons are absent, that

sign cannot be made manifest.

The third sign that they will pick up serpents can only be applicable where there are serpents. If serpents are absent, that sign too cannot be manifested.

The fourth sign that if they drink any deadly thing, it will not hurt them is already conditional. If the believer does not drink any deadly thing, that sign will never have the occasion to come to pass.

The fifth sign that they will lay their hands on the sick and they will recover will only be applicable where there are sick people. If these are absent, that sign will not be manifest.

The only sign that can always be manifested wherever there are believers is the second one that says that they will speak in new tongues. That sign can always be made manifest wherever a believer is. No other condition is necessary for its fulfilment. It therefore becomes a very important sign, the one that is opened to all believers all the time. If the Lord said that this sign would follow those who believe, then we can certainly ask Him to grant that it should follow each believer. You can personally ask that it should follow you. Do not make yourself the exception. Ask and you will receive.

The Lord worked with the early disciples. He confirmed their message by the signs that attended it, including the sign of their speaking in other tongues.

3. THE DAY OF PENTECOST.

The Bible says, *“When the day of Pentecost had come, they were all together in one place. And suddenly a sound came from heaven like the rush of a mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. And there appeared to them tongues as of fire, distributed and resting on each one of them. And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.”* (Acts 2:1-4).

There were many signs that were manifest on the day of Pentecost. These included the following:-

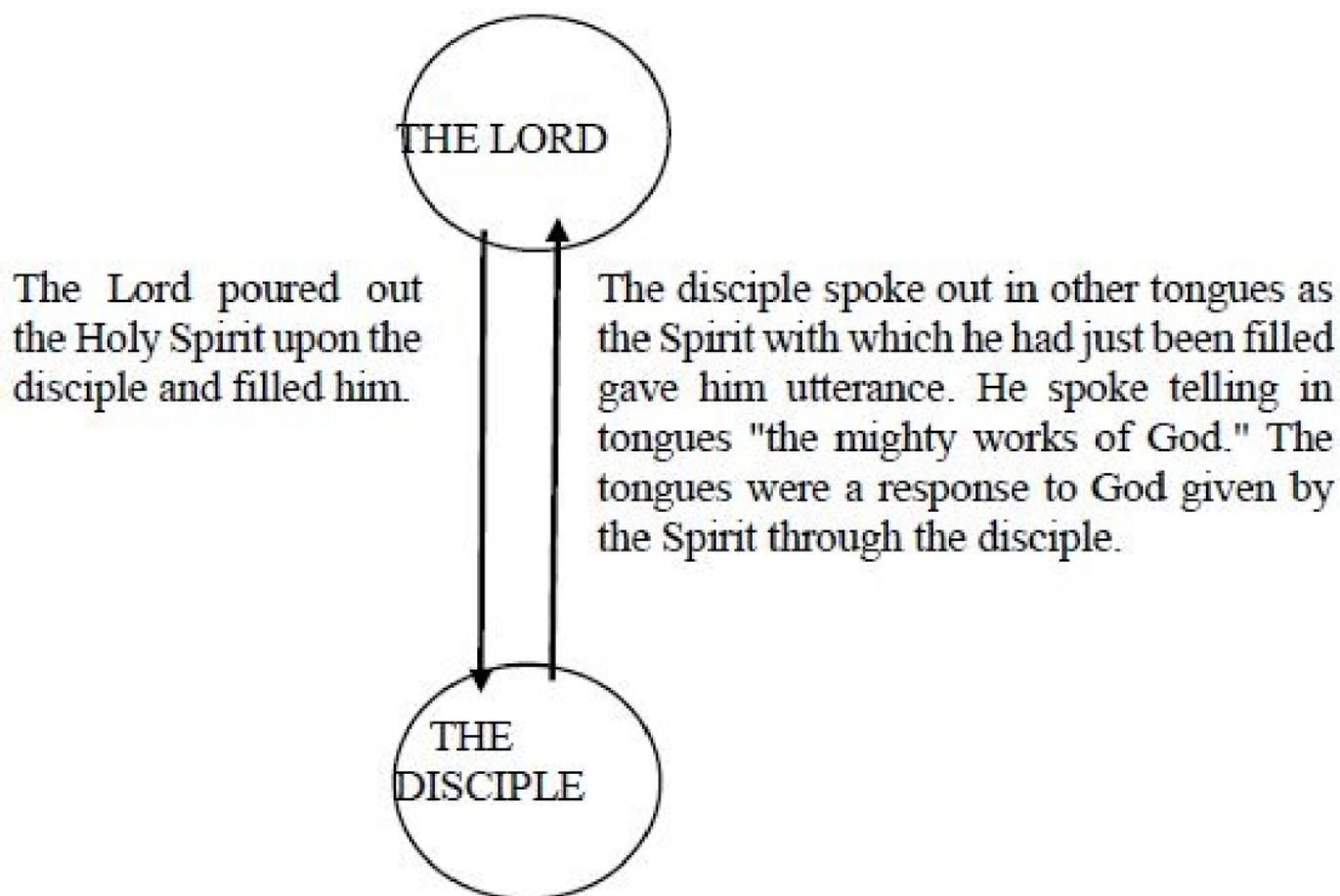
- A sudden sound from heaven like the rush of a mighty wind.
- That sound filled all the house where they were sitting.
- There appeared to them tongues as of fire.
- The tongues as of fire that appeared to them distributed and rested on each one of them.
- They began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit gave them utterance.

Among the signs that were manifest was the sign of speaking in other tongues. When did they begin to speak in other tongues? The Bible says, *“They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues.”* The most important thing that happened to them was that they were all filled with the Holy Spirit. Immediately following their being filled with the Holy Spirit was the sign, the miracle, of speaking in other

tongues. Nothing else happened between their being filled with the Holy Spirit and their speaking in other tongues. The one thing took place and was immediately followed by the other.

Someone has said that when they were filled with the Holy Spirit, it was as if they had “breathed in” the Holy Spirit in all His fullness. He filled them. There was therefore the need to “breathe out.” They “breathed out” by speaking in other tongues. As they “breathed out” speaking in other tongues, they were telling in different tongues the mighty works of God. Both were activities of God. It was the Lord who filled them with the Holy Spirit. It was the Lord who gave them utterance. However, in both events, they had a part to play: they had to co-operate with God.

For the part of being filled, they had to be available and be in a state that the Holy Spirit could fill. Without this contribution from them, God could not fill them. Then for the part of speaking in other tongues, they had to speak as the Holy Spirit gave them utterance. If they had refused to speak; if they had stubbornly closed their mouths, there would have been no speaking in tongues even though the Holy Spirit had given the utterance. He could give the utterance but He could not speak for them. They had to do the speaking. Thank God that they did.



THE DISCIPLE, HIS BEING FILLED WITH THE HOLY SPIRIT AND HIS SPEAKING IN OTHER TONGUES ON THE DAY OF PENTECOST.

The side effects of the disciples being filled on the day of Pentecost with the Holy Spirit and speaking in other tongues was that multitudes of those who were around heard them telling in their own nature tongues the mighty works of God. These were amazed and came together, which gave Peter and the other apostles the opportunity to minister to them. However, the being filled with the Holy Spirit on the day of Pentecost and the accompanying speaking in tongues were not primarily meant for the crowd, but for the disciples and their Lord.

We insist from this event that took place on the day of Pentecost that the sign that followed immediately after the disciples had been filled with

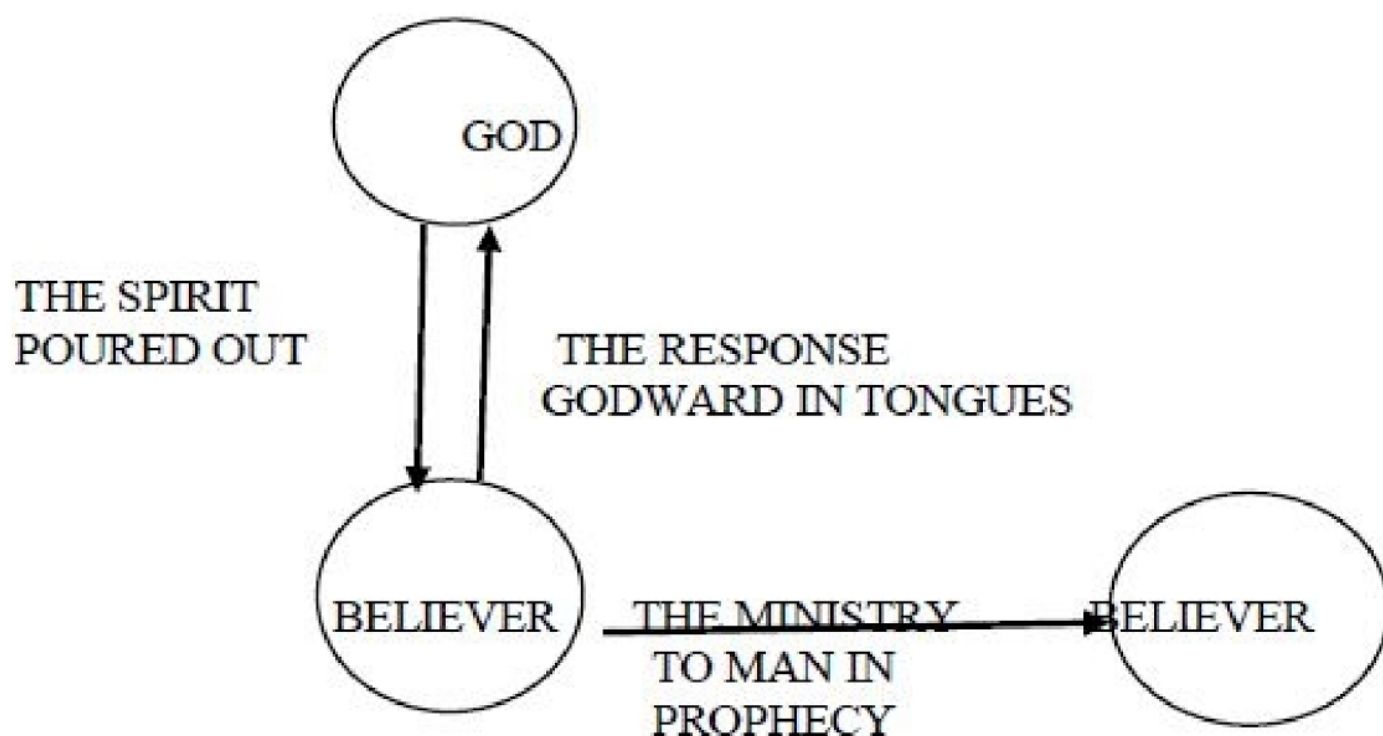
the Holy Spirit for the first time was that they spoke in other tongues. Other signs followed their subsequent fillings with the Holy Spirit, but the first filling was immediately followed by the speaking in other tongues. Other manifestations that followed subsequent fillings included the following:-

1. *"Then Peter filled with the Holy Spirit, said to them"* (Acts 4:8).
2. *"They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of God with boldness."* (Acts 4:31).

Many things will happen to people after they are filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time, but the first of them will normally always be the speaking in other tongues.

It is only normal that the first outflow of a person after he has been filled with the Holy Spirit is tongues of praise and thanksgiving to the Lord. On the day of Pentecost the by-standers said, *"We hear them telling in our own tongues the mighty works of God."* (Acts 2:11).

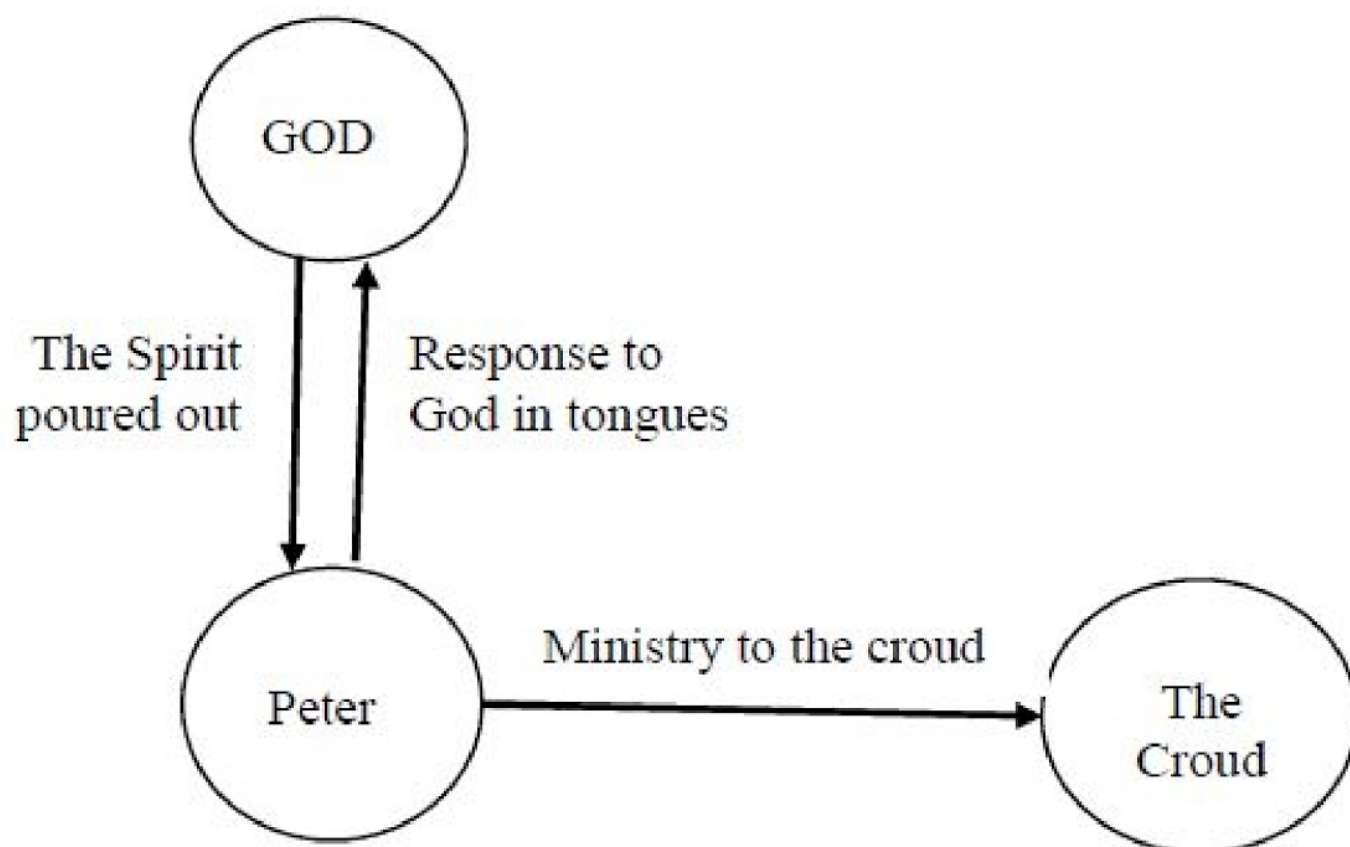
This was obviously praise to the Lord. The household of Cornelius was heard speaking in tongues and extolling God (Acts 10:46). The Ephesians spoke in tongues and prophesied (Acts 19:6). Since the Bible says that the one who speaks in tongues utters mysteries in the Spirit to God (1 Corinthians 14:2); whereas the one who prophesies speaks to men (1 Corinthians 14:3), we conclude that the Ephesians ministered first to the Lord and then to men.



THE BAPTISM OF THE EPHESIANS.

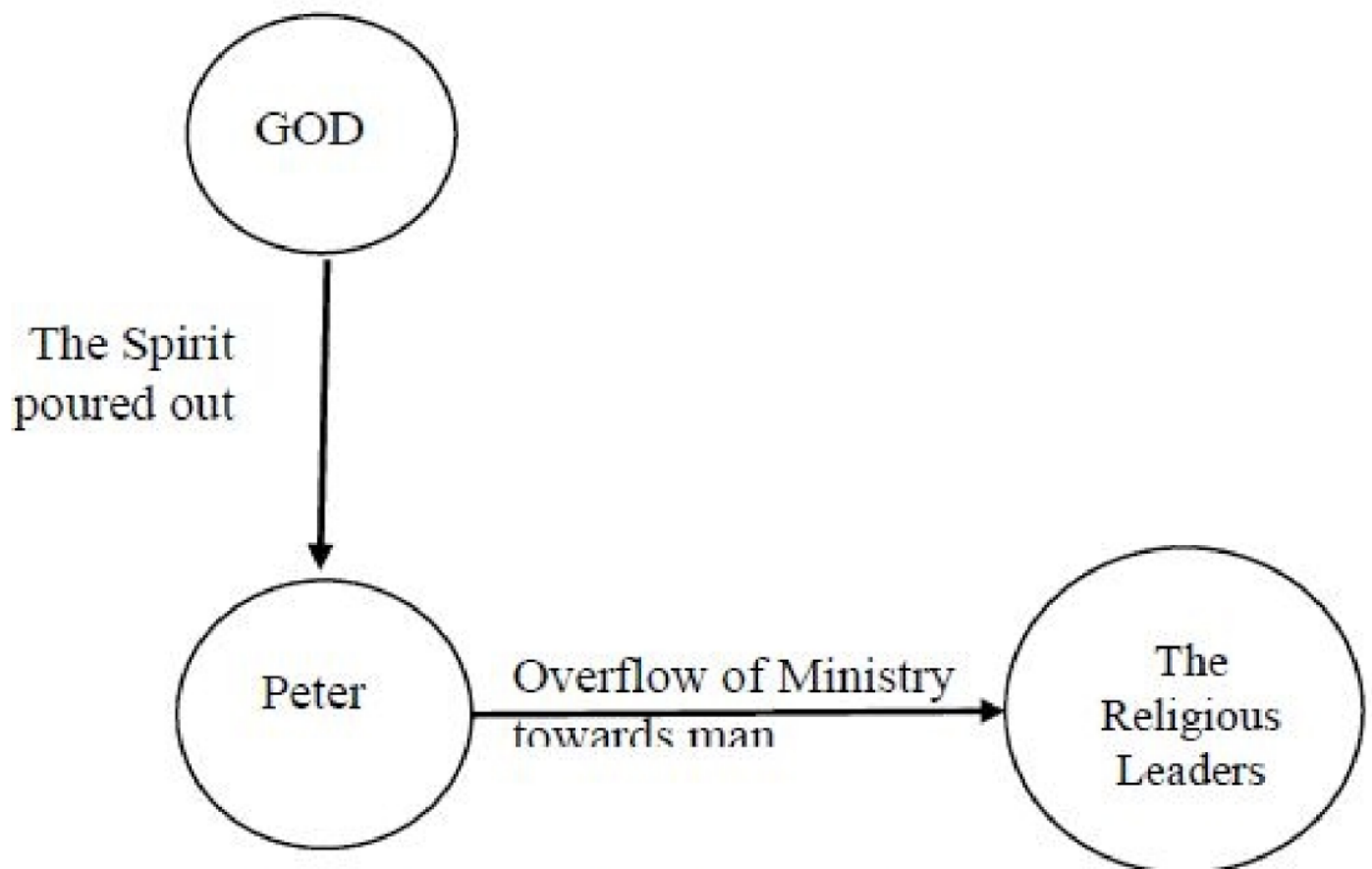
The Lord called the twelve that they should be with Him and that He might send them out to preach and heal (Mark 3:14). Thus the first purpose of the call was ministry to the Lord and only secondarily was it to be to men. The first fruits were to be offered to the Lord; the first tithe was to be offered to the Lord.

Seeing therefore the fact that the first of everything should be offered to the Lord, it is understandable that the first time a person is filled with the Holy Spirit, he should respond God-ward in tongues so that the Lord should have the first of all things for Himself. Looking at the instances when Peter is mentioned as being filled with the Spirit in the book of Acts, we see that when he was filled the first time, he manifested it God-ward in tongues, and the other times he flowed man-ward in ministry.

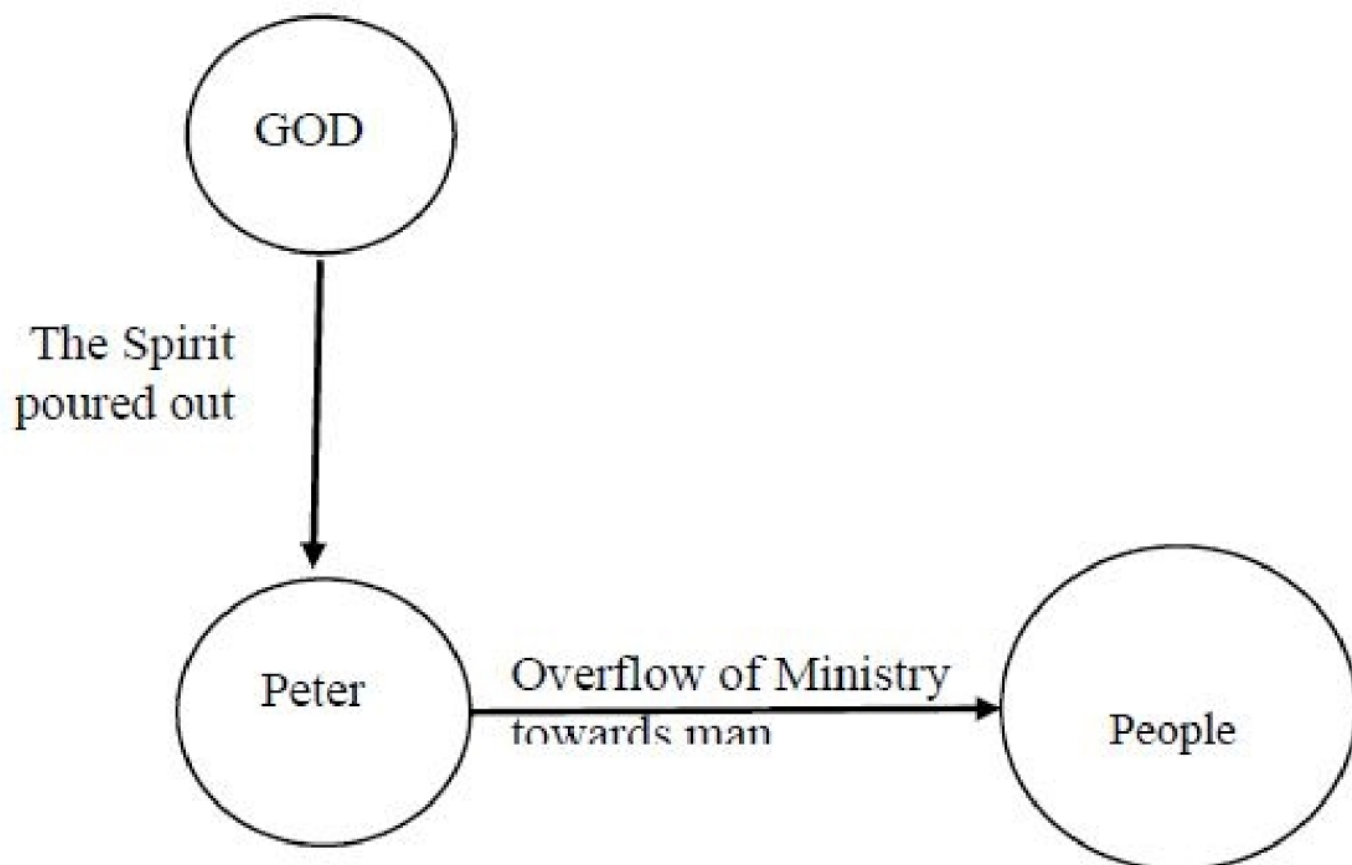


Peter was filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit gave him utterance. (Acts 2:4)

Peter stood up, lifted his voice and addressed the crowd. (Acts 2:14)



Then Peter, filled with the Spirit said to them: (There was no need here for the Godward flow in tongues since "the first fruit" had already been given to the Lord.) (Acts 4:8)



Peter and the others were all filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of God with boldness. (Acts 4:31))

The first time a person is filled with the Spirit, he normally responds God-ward in praise and thanksgiving (in tongues) to the Lord. The subsequent outflows can then be ministry to man. This puts everything in its right perspective so that all things should be done first of all for the glory of God, and secondarily to minister to the needs of man.

4. CORNELIUS AND HIS HOUSEHOLD.

The Bible says, *“While Peter was still saying this, the Holy Spirit fell on all who heard the word. And the believers from among the circumcised who came with Peter were amazed, because the gift of the Holy Spirit*

had been poured out even on the Gentiles. For they heard them speaking in tongues and extolling God. Then Peter declared, "Can any one forbid water for baptizing these people who have received the Holy Spirit just as we have?" (Acts 10:44-47).

These Gentiles believed in the course of Peter's long message. Jesus the Baptizer decided to baptize them into the Holy Spirit at once. He did and the first sign that followed this was that these Gentiles were heard "speaking in other tongues and extolling God." So the first sign was that they spoke in other tongues.

Many of the signs that were seen on the day of Pentecost when the Holy Spirit came on the disciples were absent in Cornelius' house. There were no tongues as of fire resting on the people.

There was only one sign that was present both on the day of Pentecost and in Cornelius' house. That sign was the speaking in other tongues.

Even though that was the only sign present, Peter the apostle said, *"These people have received the Holy Spirit just as we have."* (Acts 10:47). He further explained to the others, *"As I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell on them just as on us at the beginning."* (Acts 11:15). He argued, *"If then God gave the same them as he gave to us..."* (Acts 11:17).

When the apostle Peter saw the household of Cornelius speaking in tongues, he equated what happened to these people to what had happened to them on the day of Pentecost. He said that God had given to these

people the same gift, as He had given the one hundred and twenty who were filled with the Holy Spirit on the day of Pentecost. He said that these people received Holy Spirit just as they had. He further said, “the Holy Spirit fell on them just as on us.”

We conclude from these passages that when the Holy Spirit comes upon a believer and he manifests this by speaking in tongues:

1. He has received the Holy Spirit as the apostles did.
2. The Holy Spirit has fallen upon him as He fell on the apostles.
3. God has given the same gift to him as He gave the apostles.

SPEAKING IN TONGUES AND THE BAPTISM INTO THE HOLY SPIRIT.

The apostle Peter said, *“As I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell on them just as on us at the beginning. And I remember the word of the Lord, how he said, “John baptized with water, but you shall be baptized with the Holy Spirit.” If then God gave the same gift to them as he gave to us when we believed in the Lord Jesus Christ, who was I that I could withstand God? When they heard this they were silenced. And they glorified God, saying, “Then to the Gentiles also God has granted repentance unto life.” (Acts 11:15-18).*

The apostle Peter did not only equate what happened in Cornelius’ house to what happened to them on the day of Pentecost. He also equated it to the baptism into the Holy Spirit that the Lord had promised.

Before the day of Pentecost, the Lord had said to them, *“For John*

baptized with water, but before many days you shall be baptized with the Holy Spirit.” (Acts 1:5).

On the day of Pentecost, they were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Holy Spirit gave them utterance. This being filled with the Holy Spirit with the sign of speaking in other tongues following is what the Bible calls the baptism into the Holy Spirit.

A person is thus baptized into the Holy Spirit only once, but he can and should be filled many times.

The term “baptism into the Holy Spirit” talks of the first time that a person is filled with the Holy Spirit. To know that the baptism has taken place, the person should speak in tongues.

A person may be filled with the Holy Spirit but does not speak in tongues. He should not be said to have been baptized into the Holy Spirit, for the baptism is always followed by the speaking in other tongues.

When a person has been baptized into the Holy Spirit, he can only be filled on other occasions. He is not baptized many times. He is not baptized into the Holy Spirit each time he speaks in tongues. Normally, he should speak in tongues from the moment he is baptized into the Holy Spirit until he meets the Lord in the air or goes to be with Him.

5. THE BELIEVERS IN SAMARIA

The Bible says, *“But when they believed Philip as he preached the good*

news about the Kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized both men and women. Even Simon himself believed, and after being baptized he continued with Philip. And seeing signs and great miracles performed, he was amazed. Now when the apostles at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent to them Peter and John, who came down and prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit; for it had not yet fallen on any of them, but they had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. Then they laid their hands on them and they received the Holy Spirit. Now when Simon saw that the Spirit was given through the laying on of the apostles' hands he offered them money, saying, "Give me also this power, that anyone on whom I lay my hands may receive the Holy Spirit." (Acts 8:12-19).

The Samaritans had believed. They had seen many signs and great miracles performed by Philip. They were baptized in water. There was much joy in the city.

The Holy Spirit had not yet fallen on any of them. They were not yet baptized into the Holy Spirit. They had not yet received the gift of the Holy Spirit.

The apostles in Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God. They sent Peter and John who came down and prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit; for it had not yet fallen on any of them, but they had only been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.

How did the apostles know that Samaria had received the word? They knew because the people had testified to faith in Jesus and been baptized

in His Name. How did the apostles know that the Holy Spirit had not yet fallen upon the believers in Samaria? They had not spoken in other tongues as the Holy Spirit gave them utterance. That which happened to them on the day of Pentecost had not yet taken place. The obvious manifestation of speaking in other tongues had not yet been manifest. That which had taken place in Cornelius' house that convinced Peter that those people had received the Holy Spirit just as they had received Him (which was the speaking in tongues) was absent.

With that essential ingredient of speaking in other tongues absent, the apostle knew that that ministry had to take place.

The question may be asked, "Did the Samaritan believers speak in other tongues as the Holy Spirit gave them utterance or did they not? My answer to that question is, "They surely did," for if they had not spoken in tongues, how would Peter and John have known that these people did receive the Holy Spirit upon the laying on of their hands upon them? Could they have been satisfied if they had prayed for the first person that he should receive the promise of the Father and after the laying on of hands nothing happened and they went to the second person and then to the third and so on? Peter saw the evidence of speaking in other tongues in the house of Cornelius. It would be consistent that he must have seen the same evidence among the Samaritan believers in order to conclude that they had received the Holy Spirit as they the apostles had received on the day of Pentecost.

There was the demand of Simon the former sorcerer. The Bible says, *"Then they laid hands on them and they received the Holy Spirit. Now*

when Simon saw that the Spirit was given through the laying on of the apostles' hands, he offered them money, saying, "Give me also this power, that anyone on whom I lay my hands may receive the Holy Spirit." (Acts 8:17-19).

Simon saw things as follows: Before the apostles laid their hands on a person, that person had not yet received the Holy Spirit in that special way. When the apostles laid their hands and prayed, the Holy Spirit fell upon the person. What did he see? The Bible says, "when he saw that the Holy Spirit was given with the laying on of the apostles' hands..." He saw something extraordinary happen. There was evidence in each case for him to see. It was what he saw that made an impact on him and caused him to want the power to do the same thing. Simon knew the power and influence of the magical arts. He must have seen something happen that was greater than the power of magic so much that he was ready to purchase it. Would Simon have been offering money to receive the power to lay hands on people and see nothing happen? Certainly not.

We conclude that what Simon saw happen with the laying on of the apostles' hands was the same thing that Peter and the rest of the people had seen happen to them on the day of Pentecost: the speaking in other tongues. We conclude that Peter saw the same thing in the case of the Samaritans that he had seen in the house of Cornelius - the speaking in other tongues.

Finally, we add that it is only in understanding things this way that we can make sense out of Peter and John's mission to Samaria. They went there because they heard that Samaria had received the word of the Lord,

but the Holy Spirit had not yet fallen on them. They went back with a mission accomplished,. How could it have been accomplished without their being in a position to tell the other apostles at Jerusalem that the Samaritans had received the Holy Spirit as they themselves had received Him on the day of Pentecost? If you find here an exception to the fact that the baptism into the Holy Spirit is received and immediately manifested by the speaking in other tongues, you may. If you make this an exception and want to be the exception, you have made up your mind to be the exception. However, know that the Lord does not want you to be the exception. He wants to baptize you into the Holy Spirit and His Spirit wants to give you utterance so that you can speak in other tongues. Do not give away that which is a part of your inheritance.

The Bible says, *“These signs shall follow those who believe.... they will speak with new tongues...”* (Mark 16:17-18). That includes you.

6. THE EPHESIAN BELIEVERS

“While Apollos was at Corinth, Paul passed through the upper country and came to Ephesus. There he found some disciples. And he said to them, “Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?” And they said, “No, we have never even heard that there is a Holy Spirit.” And he said, “Into what then were you baptized?” They said, “Into John’s baptism.” And Paul said, “John baptized with the baptism of repentance, telling the people to believe in the one who was to come after him, that is, Jesus.” On hearing this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. And when Paul had laid his hands upon them, the Holy Spirit came on them; and they spoke with tongues and prophesied. They were

about twelve of them in all.” (Acts 19: 1-7).

The apostle Paul laid his hands on these people after they had believed and been baptized. The Holy Spirit came on them and they spoke with tongues and prophesied. Again, the first thing that happened to them after the Holy Spirit came upon them is that they spoke in tongues. To the speaking in tongues was added prophecy.

7. SAUL OF TARSUS.

Saul of Tarsus met the Lord on the Damascus road. This was followed by three days of blindness during which he neither ate nor drank. The Lord sent Ananias to him so that Saul might receive ministry. He went to Saul and said to him; *“Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus who appeared to you on the road by which you came, has sent me that you may regain your sight and be filled with the Holy Spirit.” And immediately something like scales fell from his eyes and he regained his sight. Then he arose and was baptized, and took food and was strengthened.” (Acts 9:17-19).*

Ananias said that he was sent to Saul so that

1. He might regain his sight.
2. He might be filled with the Holy Spirit.

Was Saul of Tarsus filled with the Holy Spirit? I believe that he was, since the first thing that was to happen to him (receive his sight) took place. There is no reason to suppose that the second did not take place. Did Saul of Tarsus speak in tongues immediately he was filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time? I must honestly say that I do not know. He

might have or he might not have spoken in tongues immediately. The Scriptures are silent about it. We too must maintain the same silence and say that there is one case reported in the book of Acts where someone might have been filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time, and might not have spoken immediately in tongues.

Paul (Saul) however did speak in tongues. He said to the Corinthians, “*I thank God that I speak in tongues more than you all.*” (1 Corinthians 14:18). So Saul was not exempted from this sign that the Lord said would follow all who believed. He too spoke in other tongues.

When did Saul speak in tongues for the first time? We do not know. We however know for certain that he was filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke with other tongues immediately following or some time after he was filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time.

If we take the five examples that we have cited from the book of Acts of the apostles:

- the day of Pentecost,
- the Samaritan believers,
- the house of Cornelius,
- the Ephesian believers,
- Saul of Tarsus,

we can say that four out of every five believers at least ought to speak in

other tongues immediately they are filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time. One out of every five believers may not speak in other tongues immediately they are filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time, but they should afterwards speak with other tongues. All five examples suggest that all believers ought to speak with other tongues sooner or later after they have been filled with the Holy Spirit for the first time. Taking the promise of Jesus that those who believe in Him will have the sign of speaking in other tongues following them, we confidently recommend that all believers seek the baptism into the Holy Spirit with the accompanying speaking in other tongues. We believe that all who present a pure heart to the Lord Jesus and ask Him to fill them with the Holy Spirit with the accompanying manifestation of speaking with other tongues will receive the same from the Lord Jesus; for whosoever asks receives.

Amen.

WHY TONGUES?

One question that often bothers people is why so much importance should be placed on tongues. In a sense I do not know why, for it is the Lord and not man who chose to place the emphasis on tongues. He best knows why He made that choice. In another sense, I know why He places so much emphasis on tongues. The reason is that all the other gifts of the Holy Spirit:-

- A word of wisdom,
- A word of knowledge,

- Faith,
- Discernment of spirits,
- Various kinds of healing,
- Prophecy and
- The working of miracles,

were already manifest in the Old Testament, in the life of the Lord Jesus and in the apostles prior to the day of Pentecost. The only spiritual gift that came with the coming down of the Holy Spirit upon the disciples was the speaking in tongues and the interpretation thereof. Tongues are therefore the special gift of the Holy Spirit in this dispensation. That is why it is normal that the Lord wants to give this manifestation to all His children in this dispensation as He baptizes them into the Holy Spirit.

We encourage you to receive from the Lord the special spiritual gift for this dispensation.

Amen.

Chapter 4



RECEIVING THE BAPTISM INTO THE HOLY SPIRIT 1: BEING FILLED WITH THE HOLY SPIRIT

What must a person do in order to be filled with the Holy Spirit? The answer is simple. There are two basic conditions to think about and act upon.

1. OFFER THE HOLY SPIRIT A CLEAR VESSEL TO FILL:

You want to be filled with the Holy Spirit. He is the Holy Spirit. He will only fill a vessel that is pure. This means that all sin in your life has to be confessed and forsaken. This radical treatment of sin is indispensable for the baptism into the Holy Spirit. I imagine being filled with the Holy Spirit to be like holding the “cups” of our lives out to the Lord. He then comes along with His Holy Spirit to pour Him into every cup that is clean. Each believer holds out his cup to Him so that He may fill it. He moves from believer to believer looking inside the cup of each; When he finds a cup that is clean, He pours out the Holy Spirit into it to overflowing. When He finds a dirty cup, he passes by without pouring in

anything.

You are dealing with God. He knows your heart. He knows the secrets of your heart. You cannot deceive Him with partial confessions. You cannot deceive Him with confessions of sin that do not go along with a desire to put an end to all sinful practices. Half-measures will not do. God seeks pure vessels to fill and use. Are you one of them? The Bible says, *“In a great house there are not only vessels of gold and silver but also of wood and earthenware; and some for noble use, some for ignoble. If anyone purifies himself from what is ignoble, then he will be a vessel for noble use, consecrated and useful to the master of the house, ready for any good work.”* (2 Timothy 2:20-21).

The word of God says, “If anyone purifies himself...” We are God’s children. We can purify ourselves. If we don’t, God will not do it for us. He will fill us with His Holy Spirit. We cannot do that. On the other hand, we must purify ourselves. HE will not do that.

2. CONSECRATE THE CLEAN VESSEL TO THE LORD:

It is not enough that the vessel of our lives should be purified. After it has been purified, it must be consecrated to Him. What is consecration? It is to separate a particular person or object from the use of all persons and put him or it aside completely for the use of the Lord. The apostle said, *“I appeal to you therefore brethren, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and acceptable to God, which is your spiritual worship.”* (Romans 12:1).

Consecration means that all that you are now and all that you will ever

be; all that you have now and all that you will ever have are separated from the “self” in you and separated from the world and separated from the devil. Then they are offered to the Lord Jesus so that they belong to Him and they serve Him in the way that He chooses, at the place that He chooses, in the conditions that He chooses, and for as long as He chooses. Consecration means that the one who is consecrated loses his right of self-determination in every way. He loses that right by surrendering it unconditionally and irrevocably to the Lord Jesus. Consecration means that Jesus is established - enthroned, as Lord of the life for ever. He is enthroned as Lord of all, for He is either Lord of all or He is Lord of nothing. He will not be Lord of some areas of a person’s life while other areas are controlled by the person himself or by another person, system or thing.

This matter of the Lordship of Jesus cannot be overstressed, for it is at the very root of the matter of being filled with the Holy Spirit. On the day of Pentecost, Peter said, *“This Jesus God raised up, and of that we are witnesses. Being therefore exalted at the right hand of God and having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, he has poured out this which you see and hear.”* (Acts 2:32-33).

Before the first Pentecost, the Father exalted the Son. From that exalted position on the throne the Son received the Holy Spirit and then poured Him out on the disciples. It would have been impossible for the Lord Jesus to receive the Holy Spirit and pour Him out on the disciples without being enthroned. God has ordained that all other “Personal Pentecosts” shall be preceded by an enthronement of the Lord Jesus in

the heart of the believer who desires to be filled. Without this total abandonment to the Lord Jesus, without this establishment of Him as Lord, people seek the baptism into the Holy Spirit in vain. It is fair. Is it not? How can the Lord Jesus baptize anyone into the Holy Spirit who has someone else or something else on his heart? A person is normally filled by that which is on the throne of his heart. When there is something else there, there is no possibility for a person to be baptized into the Holy Spirit until that thing is dethroned and the Lord is enthroned. One thing to note is that this dethroning of something else that is on the heart and the enthroning of the Lord Jesus can take place in a very short time. A person can come into a meeting with something or someone on his heart and during the meeting yield absolutely to the Lord and be filled with the Holy Spirit.

What things may occupy the throne of the heart of a person and thereby make it impossible to be filled with the Holy Spirit? Below is a list of some of the things that come into my mind at the moment:-

1. SELF IN ALL ITS FORMS AND RAMIFICATIONS:

self-love

self-protection

self-display

self-advertisement

self-promotions

self-congratulations

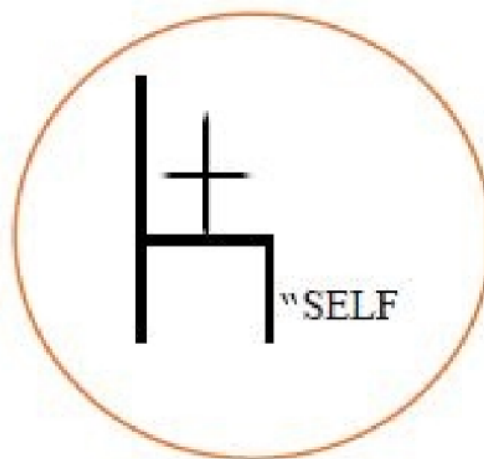
self-pity

etc.



A

Cannot be filled
with the Holy Spirit



B

Can be filled with
the Holy Spirit

The circle represents the human heart. The chair represents the heart. In this life, self, "I" is on the throne. The Lord, represented by the Cross, "+" is in the heart but not on the throne in A. The person is a believer but he is not consecrated. He cannot be filled with the Holy Spirit in this condition. In order to be filled, the Lord Jesus must be consciously and actively put on the throne as in B.

2. UNCONSECRATED EMOTIONS.

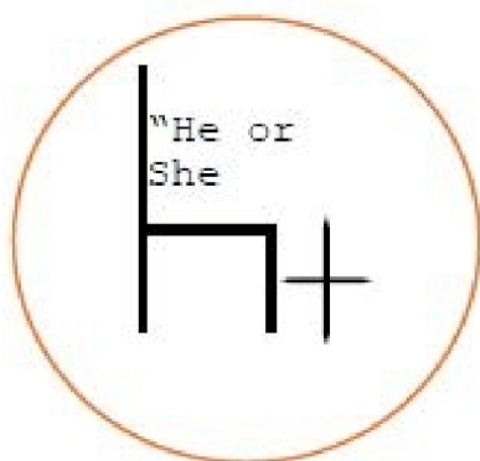
The Lord demanded and demands total love. The Bible says, *"And you shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, and with all your*

might.” (Deuteronomy 6:5).

The heart is to love the Lord. The heart is that part of the human spirit that controls the emotional functions of the soul. The love of the heart is the love of emotions. If there is any other love on the throne of your heart, you cannot be filled with the Holy Spirit until that other love has been dethroned and Jesus enthroned. The Psalmist said, “*Whom have I in heaven but thee? And there is nothing upon earth that I desire besides thee.*” (Psalm 73:25).

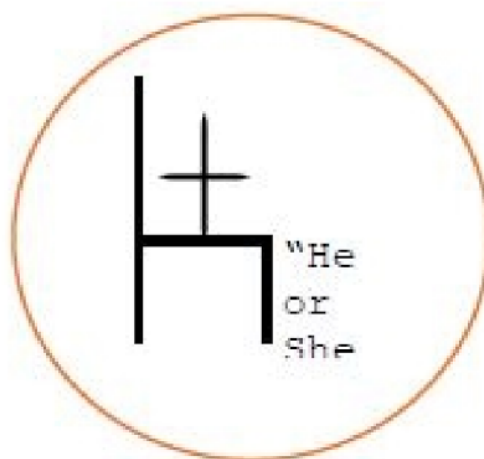
Can you too say with him that there is no one else on earth that you desire besides the Lord? If there is anyone else that you desire in addition to the Lord, then your heart is not perfect towards God. You cannot be filled with the Holy Spirit until things have changed. The person on the throne of your heart could be your wife or husband, your fiancée or fiancé; your boyfriend or girlfriend, your friend, your father, mother or anyone else. There is a real problem here. If you fall in love with someone, you will begin to want to please him in all things. You may want to dress to please him, go to places to please him and buy things to please him. How can the Holy Spirit have absolute sway in your life when you are living to please some human personality? The consecration of your emotions will mean that you are prepared to remain single all your life should that be the will of the Lord for you. Are you willing to surrender your right to marriage? Are you prepared to make yourself a eunuch for the gospel should the Lord so demand it from you? Without this unreserved surrender of the emotional life to the Lord, the baptism into the Holy Spirit is impossible, for the Lord Jesus baptizes from the

throne.



A

Cannot be filled
with the Holy Spirit



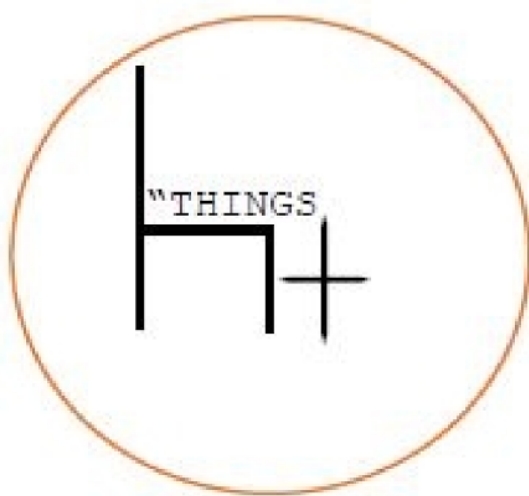
B

Can be filled with
the Holy Spirit

3. UNCONSECRATED PURPOSES AND THINGS.

The Lord Jesus demands absolute Lordship of all that a person possesses and all that he wants to be. Anyone with unconsecrated wealth is unsundered. The one way to show that wealth has been consecrated is to put it into the needs of the gospel enterprise or hold it out to the Lord at his command. The person who wants to be filled with the Holy Spirit will surrender everything to the Lord and then wait on the Lord for instructions on how to use it. He has no more ambitions in the world. He lives only to serve Jesus. He lives to glorify Jesus. He is not seeking to be promoted by the world. He is not seeking a career in the world. His career is to serve the Lord Jesus and he may practise law, medicine, and so on, not as his profession, but as that which he does in order to pay the expenses that are incurred in his career of serving Jesus. He has ceased to

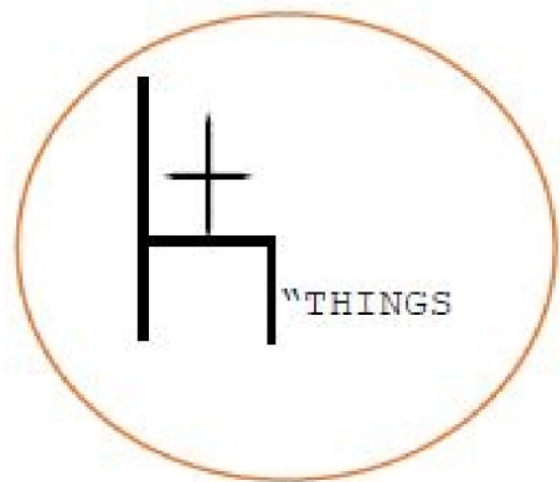
bother about the praise or the blame of the world. He is indifferent to either. He is also indifferent to the promotions or demotions of the world. He seeks to be promoted in the heart and estimation of God. He is unmoved by the appointments or disappointments of men. He knows that he has been appointed from above. He has long ceased to desire things. He empties his heart of all else so that he may be filled with the Holy Spirit.



A

Cannot be filled
with the Holy Spirit

Unsurrendered in
purpose and possession



B

Can be filled with
the Holy Spirit

Surrendered in purpose
and possession

Let us add that the person desiring to be filled with the Holy Spirit must surrender all to the Lordship of Jesus. However, all we ask is real

honesty before God. In practice, it will be found that the last surrender was not enough; that some things were left out or we were not as thorough as we could be. So there will be the major crisis of surrender preceding our being baptized into the Holy Spirit and the subsequent minor crises of surrender preceding our subsequent being filled with the Holy Spirit. Those who walk close to God will find that after they are baptized into the Holy Spirit, they need to be filled with the Holy Spirit in a daily or even hourly basis in order to maintain continued overflow.

THE ACT OF BEING FILLED WITH THE HOLY SPIRIT

The Lord yearns to fill His children with the Holy Spirit. The Spirit-filled life is God's normal life for His children. Anything less than that is subnormal. The unfortunate thing is that there are so many believers whose lives are sub-normal and such few believers whose lives are normal that many now think of that which is seen all around as normal and consider the normal which is rare as something else! Anyone who is not filled with the Holy Spirit is a sub-normal believer. He should normalize things. Anyone who is filled with the Holy Spirit has not done anything that is extraordinary. He is just being what all believers ought to be. So, when a person asks the Lord to fill him, the Lord will be just too willing to do so.

Now before you ask the Lord to fill you with the Holy Spirit for the first time, that is, baptize you into the Holy Spirit, may I ask you some questions? They are these. Are you prepared to be filled, possessed and led by Another Spirit who will own you for Himself and often against many of your own plans and ambitions? Are you prepared to be

possessed by Another Spirit who will bring to nought all the selfish plans that you have made to make a name and a reputation in the world? Are you prepared to be filled by Another Spirit who may tell you and lead you to go and confess the sins that you have been hiding in your heart to someone? Are you prepared to be possessed by Another Spirit who may lead you in the way of poverty as far as worldly goods are concerned so that you may follow in the pathway of the Baptizer who had no place to lay His head? Are you prepared to be led by Another Spirit who will frustrate your plans to win the world and the honour thereof? Are you prepared to be possessed by Another Spirit who will lead you to obeying all of the Word of God with no room left for your own inclinations, preferences or prejudices? Are you prepared to be led by Another Spirit who may lead you into much suffering for the gospel for the rest of your life? Are you prepared to be led by Another Spirit who may lead you to serve the Lord in a place of total obscurity from men and hide all the impact of your ministry from men so that you receive no knowledge from man until the Lord Jesus shall come to judge the saints and reward them?

If you are not prepared for all of these things and more, do not ask the Holy Spirit to fill you. If he comes in fullness, so much will have to go out, and with your present condition you will be frustrated. However, if you are prepared to be led by Another Spirit who will lead you where He wants, when He wants and for the reason that He wants, ask Him to fill you. The Lord Jesus told the disciple Peter before Pentecost, *“Truly, truly, I say to you, when you were young, you girded yourselves and walked where you would, but when you are old, you will stretch out your*

hands, and another will gird you and carry you where you do not wish to go.” (John 21:18).

Yes, to be filled by the Holy Spirit is also to be led and controlled by Another. This means that there must be a fundamental commitment to dying to self.

You can now ask the Holy Spirit to fill you. You do not need to talk for long. Pray as follows or with other words of your own, “Lord, fill me with the Holy Spirit now. Amen.”

If you prayed that prayer sincerely, and if your heart is such that the Holy Spirit can fill, then He has done it at once. He does not take long to do it.

You are filled with the Holy Spirit by faith. The Bible says, “*if you can, all things are possible to him who believes.*” (Mark 9:23). “*Have you believed because you have seen me? Blessed are those who have not seen and yet believed.*” (John 20:29). The apostle said, “*And this is the confidence which we have in Him, that if we ask anything according to His will, he hears us. And if we know that he hears us in whatever we ask, we know that we have obtained the request made of him.*” (1 John 5:14-15). The Bible again says, “*Have faith in God. Truly, I say to you, whoever says to this mountain, “Be taken up and cast into the sea, and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says will come to pass, it will be done for him. Therefore I tell you whatever you ask in prayer, believe that you have received it and it will be yours.*” (Mark 11:22-24).

baptized into the Holy Spirit.

Chapter 5



RECEIVING THE BAPTISM INTO THE HOLY SPIRIT 2: SPEAKING IN OTHER TONGUES

The baptism into the Holy Spirit is the first experience in being filled with the Holy Spirit. It is normally followed immediately by the speaking in other tongues. The speaking in tongues is a miracle sign. Therefore, the normal route to the performance of miracles will be followed by this sign as well.

There are two sides to each miracle. There is what is done by man and there is what is done by the Lord. Man cannot do God's part and God has decided that He will not do man's part. Let us look at these two parts in a number of miracles recorded in the Bible.

1. THE HEALING OF THE MAN WITH A WITHERED HAND (MARK 3:1-5)

The Lord's part was to speak and make it happen. He said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." The man was to stretch out his withered hand

while it was still withered. The Lord did not stretch out the hand for the man. He could do it, and the Lord will not do what we can do for ourselves. We must do what we can do. If the man had not had faith, he would not have stretched out his withered hand. He believed Jesus and believed that Jesus knew what He was saying. He put his faith into action. He stretched out the withered hand and as he did, God gave the miracle and the outstretched hand was healed in the process of being stretched. If the man had decided that he would see (the miracle) his hand healed and then he would believe the Lord and stretch it out, then he would have remained with a withered hand all his life.

So, God's part was:

1. To speak the word of healing.
2. To make it good.
3. And, man's part was:
4. To stretch forth his hand.

When the two came together, a miracle took place.

2. PETER, WALKING ON THE SEA. (MATTHEW 14:28-31).

Man's part:

1. Peter desired to go to Jesus at sea.
2. Peter made the request.

In the miracle of speaking in tongues, there is God's part and there is man's part.

Man's part consists in:

1. Believing that God has filled him with the Holy Spirit as he has asked in prayer. If a person doubts God about this, he cannot expect to believe God for the next steps. The problem is often not that God has not filled a person, but that people who have been filled refuse to accept by faith that God has done it.
2. Speak out. He must open his mouth and begin to speak trusting the Lord to give him the language - the utterance. On the day of Pentecost it was not the Holy Spirit or the Lord who began to speak. It was the disciples who began to speak as the Lord gave them utterance. If they had closed their mouths firmly and had not opened them, then they would not have spoken in tongues. The Holy Spirit will not speak in man's place. He will not force the mouth of anyone against the person's will so that the person may begin to speak in other tongues. He will move in and through those who are prepared to co-operate with Him. Many people have testified that they held their mouths firmly closed after they had asked the Lord to fill them with the Holy Spirit and resisted all inward pressures for them to speak. This was often because of long-standing fears and prejudices about the speaking in tongues.

God's part consists in:

3. Giving the utterance - the syllable, the word, the words, the phrases and the sentences.

When a person has asked the Lord to fill him, often he will sense an inner compulsion to speak out. Sometimes, he will feel as if he is choking and therefore should open his mouth and find release by speaking. Others have found something welling inside them that they could not contain. Others have felt nothing, but because they should flow upward to God in tongues of praise as the first fruits unto God for their baptism into the Holy Spirit, they have just opened their mouths and begun to speak out and the first words that came were in another language. Regardless of what you feel inside your mouth or throat after you have asked the Lord to fill you with His Holy Spirit, believe that He has done so and immediately open your mouth and speak out in a new tongue. You speak out by faith and the Lord will make your faith good by causing the tongues to flow out.

The tongue may initially be just the babbling of lips, it may be just one or two phrases or it may be many sentences or a long speech of many hours. Do not bother about its length. It is praise going up to the Lord. You will not understand what you are saying, but go on. Open your mouth and speak out. The reason why many shake and tremble in meetings, or parts of their bodies tremble and shake is because they would not speak out in tongues. When the power of the Lord is released in a person or upon a person, it wants to flow upward in praise to the Lord in a tongue. If the person will not open his mouth and praise the Lord, then there will be a problem of how the power is to be released and

that struggling will cause the shaking and all the other reactions. I call them frustrating reactions; for the Holy Spirit is being frustrated in His desire to praise the Lord in another tongue through the human spirit.

There are times when people begin to speak in tongues, and the enemy then tells them that there is nothing really happening and that the language they are speaking is no language at all but noises of their own creation. Many have been forced by that suggestion, “You are making it yourself,” to stop speaking in tongues. This doubt is from the enemy and we are not ignorant of his devices. Others have been made to feel that their tongues were from the devil. This is again a trick of the devil. Can you ask the Lord to fill you with the Holy Spirit and He allows you to be filled by the devil? My answer to that is a vehement No! Can He fill you with the Holy Spirit and allow the devil to put a new language on your lips? I say, “No! No! No!” The Bible says, *“What father among you, if his son asks for a fish, will instead of a fish give him a serpent, or if he asks for an egg, will give a scorpion? If you then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask Him!”* (Luke 11:11-13). The Lord Jesus is here saying that you will not ask the Father for the Holy Spirit and receive an evil spirit. You will not ask for a tongue from the Lord and receive a tongue from Satan. Use the tongue that you have received to praise the Lord. It is from Him. It is not from the enemy. Praise the Lord!

To conclude, ask the Lord to fill you with the Holy Spirit now. Be filled now by faith. Ask and receive now by faith. Now that you have received,

Chapter 6

THE BAPTISM INTO THE HOLY SPIRIT AND SPIRITUAL GIFTS

When a person is baptized into the Holy spirit, he will speak in other tongues. This is for his private ministry to the Lord and to himself. Every believer should speak in tongues in private. This speaking in tongues as an accompaniment of the baptism into the Holy Spirit is not to be confused with the spiritual gift of diversities of tongues (1 Corinthians 12:10). It also says, “..... *Administrators, speakers in various kinds of tongues..*” (1 Corinthians 12:28). The Bible asks, after talking about speakers in various kinds of tongues, “*Do all speak with tongues?*” (1 Corinthians 12:29). The tongues here being referred to are the same as the various kinds of tongues mentioned in the preceding verse just as “healers” in verse 28 is the same as “possess gifts of healing” of verse 29.

Every believer does not have the spiritual gift of speaking in various kinds of tongues. This is for some believers, for this gift, along with the others, is given by the Holy Spirit as He wills. However, the sign of speaking in tongues, which is given to those who believe (Mark 16:17) is

for all believers.

You may ask, “What is the difference between speaking in tongues (also called speaking in other tongues) and various kinds of tongues?” The difference is that all believers receive the sign of speaking in tongues at the baptism into the Holy Spirit. In addition to this, each believer receives one or more of the following gifts for ministry:

speaking in tongues (for all believers) + one or more of the following:	A word of wisdom	}	Gifts of extraordinary manifestations
	A word of knowledge		
	Faith		
	The working of miracles		
	Prophecy		
	Discernment of spirits		
	Various kinds of tongues		
	Interpretations of tongues		
	Gifts of healing		
	Helps	}	Motivational gifts
	Administration (Government)		
	Exhortation		
	Giving (Contribution)		
	Mercy		
	Service		
	Apostle	}	Gift of men
	Prophet		
	Evangelist		
	Pastor		
	Teacher		

All believers should have one or more of these.

Only those who have the gift of various kinds of tongues should minister in public with that gift. Those who speak in tongues as a manifestation of

1. POWER TO PRODUCE SIGNS AND WONDERS:

Peter and John were approached by a lame man for financial help. The Bible says, *“Seeing Peter and John about to go into the temple, he asked for alms. And Peter directed his gaze at him, with John, and said, ”Look at us.” And he fixed his attention upon them, expecting to receive something from them. But Peter said, “I have no silver and gold, but I give you what I have; in the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, walk.” And he took him by the right hand and raised him up; and immediately his feet and ankles were made strong. And leaping up he stood and walked and entered the temple with them, walking and leaping and praising God. And all the people saw him walking and praising God, and recognized him as the one who sat for alms at the Beautiful Gate of the temple; and they were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him.”* (Acts 3:3-10).

The Bible continues to say, *“Now many signs and wonders were done among the people by the hands of the apostles. And they were all together in Solomon’s Portico. None of the rest dared join them, but the people held them in high honour. And more than ever believers were added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women, so that they even carried out the sick into the streets, and laid them on beds and pallets, that as Peter came by at least his shadow might fall on some of them. The people also gathered from around Jerusalem, bringing the sick and those afflicted with unclean spirits, and they were all healed.”* (Acts 5:12-16).

Again the Bible says, *“And Stephen, full of grace and power, did great*

wonders and signs among the people.” (Acts 6:6). The Bible continues to say, “Now those who were scattered went about preaching the word. Philip went down to a city of Samaria and proclaimed to them the Christ. And the multitude with one accord gave heed to what was said by Philip, when they heard him and saw the signs which he did. For unclean spirits came out of many who were possessed, crying with a loud voice; and many who were paralysed or lame were healed. So there was much joy in that city.” (Acts 8:4-8).

The Word of God continues to say, “Now as Peter went here and there among them all, he came down also to the saints that lived at Lydda. There he found a man named Aeneas, who had been bed-ridden for eight years and was paralysed. And Peter said to him, ”Aeneas, Jesus Christ heals you; rise and make your bed.” And immediately he rose. And all the residents of Lydda and Sharon saw him, and they turned to the Lord. Now there was at Joppa a disciple named Tabitha, which means Dorcas. She was full of good works and acts of charity. In those days she fell sick and died; and when they had washed her, they laid her in an upper room. Since Lydda was near Joppa, the disciples hearing that Peter was there, sent two men to him entreating him, “Please come to us without delay.” So Peter rose and went with them. And when he had come, they took him to the upper room. All the widows stood beside him weeping, and showing tunics and other garments which Dorcas made while she was with them. But Peter put them all outside and knelt down and prayed; then turning to the body he said, “Tabitha, rise.” And she opened her eyes and when she saw Peter she sat up. And he gave her his hand and lifted her up. Then calling the saints and widows he presented

her alive. And it became known throughout all Joppa, and many believed in the Lord.” (Acts 9:32-42).

The Bible continues to say, “But Elymas the magician (for that is the meaning of his name) withstood them, seeking to turn away the proconsul from the faith. But Saul, who is also called Paul, filled with the Holy Spirit, looked intently at him and said, ”You son of the devil, you enemy of all righteousness, full of deceit and villainy, will you not stop making crooked the straight paths of the Lord? And now, behold, the hand of the Lord is upon you, and you shall be blind and unable to see the sun for a time.” Immediately mist and darkness fell upon him and he went about seeking people to lead him by the hand. Then the proconsul believed, when he saw what had occurred, for he was astonished at the teaching of the Lord.” (Acts 13:8-12).

“Now at Iconium they entered together into the Jewish synagogue, and so spoke that a great company believed, both of Jews and of Greeks. But the unbelieving Jews stirred up the Gentiles and poisoned their minds against the brethren. So they remained for a long time, speaking boldly for the Lord, who bore witness to the word of his grace, granting signs and wonders to be done by their hands. But the people of the city were divided; some sided with the Jews, and some with the apostles. When an attempt was made by both Gentiles and Jews, with their rulers, to molest them and to stone them, they learned of it and fled to Lystra and Derbe, cities of Lycaonia, and to the surrounding country; and there they preached the gospel. Now, at Lystra there was a man sitting, who could not use his feet; he was a cripple from birth, who had never walked. He

listened to Paul speaking; and Paul, looking intently at him and seeing that he had faith to be made well, said in a loud voice, "Stand upright on your feet." And he sprang up and walked." (Acts 14:1-10).

The Bible continues to say, *"As we were going to the place of prayer, we were met by a slave girl who had a spirit of divination and brought her owners much gain by soothsaying. She followed Paul and us saying, "These men are servants of the Most High God who proclaim to you the way of salvation." And this she did for many days. But Paul was annoyed, and turned and said to the spirit, "I charge you in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her." And it came out that very hour."* (Acts 16:16-18).

The Bible continues to say, *"And God did extraordinary miracles by the hands of Paul so that handkerchiefs or aprons were carried away from his body to the sick, and diseases left them and the evil spirits came out of them."* (Acts 19:11-12).

We see that power that came on the disciples enabled them to perform miracles in the name of the Lord. The signs and miracles were used by the Lord to bring many people to the Lord. Following the signs and wonders, the Bible says,

And more than ever believers were added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women (Acts 5:14).

And the multitude with one accord gave heed to what was said by Philip when they heard him and saw the signs which he did (Acts 8:6).

all the words of this life.” (Acts 5:20). They obeyed and re-appeared before the authorities where they proclaimed the word of the Lord with boldness, authority and without compromise. This resulted in their being beaten, and further charged not to speak in the name of the Lord Jesus. Of course they refused promising not to speak in the name of Jesus. Peter and the rest of the apostles were not sad but instead they counted it a privilege to suffer dishonour for the name of Christ. (Acts 5:17-42). Spirit-filled people who count it a privilege to suffer shame for the name of Jesus will know spiritual power!

4. When James was killed, Peter was arrested and locked with the intention that he too would be killed eventually. (Acts 12:1-11).
5. Peter continued to suffer for the Lord and sealed his testimony with his blood.

The power that he received on the day of Pentecost as he was baptized into the Holy Spirit was kept in the right condition as he suffered for the Lord.

2. STEPHEN

He was one of the deacons who was appointed. He was full of faith and the Holy Spirit. He was also full of grace and power. He did great wonders and signs among the people. When some religious men could not withstand the wisdom and Spirit with which he spoke, they brought a false charge against him. He was brought before the council and accused. When he was allowed to speak, he spoke to glorify the Lord Jesus in all

truth and by that sermon he brought his ministry and career to an end; for they dragged him and stoned him to death. He thus sealed his testimony with his blood.

3. PHILIP

He went to Samaria pushed, not by ease or pleasure, but by the severe persecution that followed the martyrdom of Stephen and the beginning of Saul's career as a persecutor of the Church. He proclaimed the gospel to multitudes and the multitudes saw the signs which he did, for unclean spirits came out of many who were possessed, crying with a loud voice; and many who were paralysed or lame were healed (Acts 8:1-8). We do not know of his special further suffering for the Lord and the gospel.

4. PAUL

He himself summed it up as follows: *“Five times I have received at the hands of the Jews the forty lashes less one. Three times I have been beaten with rods; once I was stoned. Three times I have been shipwrecked; a night and a day I have been adrift at sea; on frequent journeys, in dangers from rivers, dangers from robbers, dangers from my own people, dangers from Gentiles, danger in the city, danger in the wilderness, danger at sea, danger from false brethren; in toil and hardship, through many a sleepless night, in hunger and thirst, often without food, in cold and exposure.”* (11 Corinthians 11:24-27).

When he was imprisoned, he did not complain. He was not bitter. In the Philippian jail, into which they were thrown (after “the crowd joined in attacking them; and the magistrates tore the garments off them and gave orders to beat them with rods. And they had inflicted many blows upon

4. POWER TO GIVE THEMSELVES TO PRIOR ISSUES.

When there was a problem of widows not having proper care, the apostles immediately discerned that others needed to be appointed to the task while they themselves gave themselves to prayer and the word. That was part of the secret of their power. They concentrated on what had to be done by them and let others do what was theirs to do. When people take on themselves duties and responsibilities that God has not given them, they cause confusion in the Body of Christ and lose spiritual power in themselves.

The apostles gave themselves to the most difficult and yet the most important tasks: Prayer and the word. Those who seek the easiest tasks will find it difficult to either maintain spiritual power or wield spiritual power.

5. POWER TO SPEAK IN SUCH A WAY THAT THE SPEECH CAUSED EFFECTS.

The disciples performed many miracles before Pentecost. There are a number of things that they received with the baptism into the Holy Spirit. One of them was the capacity to cause a reaction in those who heard them. The Bible says, *“When they heard this they were cut to their hearts.”* (Acts 2:37). *“As they were speaking to the people, the priests and the captain of the temple and the Sadducees came upon them, annoyed because they were teaching the people and proclaiming in Jesus the resurrection from the dead. And they arrested them and put them in custody until the morrow..”* (Acts 4:1-3). *“Now, when they saw the boldness of Peter and John, and perceived that they were uneducated,*

common men, they wondered.” (Acts 4:13). “Now when they heard these things they were enraged, and they ground their teeth against him.. But they cried out with a loud voice and stopped their ears and rushed together upon him.” (Acts 7:54-57). “And the multitudes with one accord gave heed to what was said by Philip.” (Acts 8:6). “And in the synagogues immediately he proclaimed Jesus saying, ”He is the Son of God.” And all who heard him were amazed.” (Acts 9:21). Paul’s messages caused both revolutions and riots. They allowed people no neutrality. They forced people to take sides. This was the manifestation of spiritual power.

6. POWER TO CONDEMN SIN: POWER TO BE HOLY.

There was holiness in the early church. The two people who planned and carried out deceit were rebuked by Peter for lying not to man but to the Holy Spirit and they dropped dead. This clearly shows the fact that Peter was not living in any kind of deceit and not telling occasional lies or exaggerations. It also indicates that the other members of the church were not practising this or similar sins. Because of the high standard of holiness, the power of the Holy Spirit moved to remove the slightest trace of sin that was being brought in. Great fear came upon all the believers and unbelievers who heard of it (Acts 5:1-11).

Later on when Peter tried to play the slightest hypocrisy by withdrawing from eating with the Gentile believers on the arrival of the Judaizers, Paul confronted him publicly and rebuked him (Galatians 2:11-12).

Sin was not tolerated. It was dealt with radically and the Holy Spirit was thus allowed to manifest His power in a great way. When sin was

allowed in the churches, some believers began to be weak, others sick, and some died. The power of the Holy Spirit could not manifest itself in full measure while sin also abounded.

The restoration of Spiritual power to those who are baptized into the Holy Spirit today will demand a radical separation from all sin or radical judgment for all sin. There can be no full manifestation of the power of the Holy Spirit while sin abounds either in the lives of those who lead churches or in believers in general. Sin will always cause the power of the Holy Spirit to be limited. The easiest way to limit the power of the Holy Spirit is to practise sin or tolerate it.

7. POWER TO RENDER IMPLICIT OBEDIENCE TO THE LORD.

The gift of the Holy Spirit is for those who obey the Lord. The power of the Holy Spirit will be fully manifested only in those who fully obey the Lord. In the early church, the apostles said, “*We must obey God rather than men,*” (Acts 5:29), and they did.

Philip obeyed the Lord in great detail. He was being used mightily in Samaria in an evangelistic and church-planting ministry that was heavily backed by signs and wonders. The apostles came from Jerusalem, and Samaria had her “Pentecost.” One would have thought that was time for him to settle there and make it his base. Whatever thoughts he had in his mind, the Holy Spirit had His. The Bible says, “*But an angel of the Lord said to Philip, ”Rise and go towards the south to the road that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza.”* (Acts 8:26).

What did he do? Did he send a message to the apostles in Jerusalem to

Lord? Where are churches where the Holy Spirit can visit in judgment and find only two people practising the sin of lying?

5. Where are leaders who know apostolic consecration, apostolic power and apostolic purity and piety?

With things as they are, is there any wonder that those who receive the same baptism into the Holy Spirit that the apostles received are thus blocked from doing what the apostles and the early deacons (Stephen and Philip) did? The problem is not with the baptism into the Holy Spirit that people have received, but with what is done after they are baptized.

The early disciples were not only baptized into the Holy Spirit. They were filled over and over again and thus they maintained Spirit-filled lives and Spirit-filled power. Where are those who maintain the same condition of being frequently filled afresh with the Holy Spirit?

The sad thing is that many continue to speak in tongues after they have grieved and quenched the Holy Spirit. The tongues are not withdrawn because the gifts and the calling of God are without repentance; are irrevocable (Romans 11:29). Many who speak in tongues have since lost the intimacy with the Lord and the consecration which they knew at the time when they were first baptized into the Holy Spirit. They have quenched the Holy Spirit and grieved Him so much so that He has had to withdraw to some “corner” of their lives where His Lordship is hardly felt. Meanwhile, these people have continued to speak in other tongues and even to prophesy and pass for Spirit-filled people. Of course, they are far from being filled with the Holy Spirit. We have known people

who, although they once walked close to the Lord and were pure and consecrated when the Holy Spirit first came upon them, have continued to:speak in tongues

interpret tongues

prophecy

carry out some healing ministry

and ministered in diverse ways,

and yet were living in:gluttony

lying

selfishness

immorality

deceit

anger

pride

covetousness

laziness, etc.

The gifts have continued to be manifested in their lives, but the people

have long since stopped walking with God. They are like Samson was when he went to a harlot in Gaza, but at midnight he had enough power to take hold of the doors of the gates of the city and the two posts, and pull them up, bar and all, and put them on his shoulders and carried them away at night and thereby escaped being killed by the people of the city. They may be like Saul who on one of his pursuits of David nevertheless on his way to Ramah stripped off his clothes and prophesied before Samuel and lay naked all that day and all that night before Samuel, thus causing people to ask, "Is Saul also among the prophets?" (1 Samuel 19:22-24). He had murderous intentions. He had not repented of them nor forsaken them. The Holy Spirit nevertheless came upon him and he prophesied. After he prophesied, he went on in his attempts to murder David whom God had already anointed king in his place.

Samson and Saul were used while continuing in sin, but for how long? Are you in the same condition in which they were? Are you continuing to manifest some spiritual gifts while your heart is not correct before God? Do not be deceived. It could indeed be that God is using you as He did Samson and Saul, but for how long did He use them? Were they not used then? Were they not used only for a while? You too will soon be put aside. You are doing God the greatest dishonour by continuing to manifest spiritual gifts while living in sin. God will soon put you aside unless you repent at once. God has endured your service and sin for too long. He says, "I am fed up with gifts mixed with sin; ministry and iniquity! Your tongues, prophecies, healing, visions, and the like, My Soul hates. Wash yourself; make yourself clean; remove the evil of your doing from before my eyes; cease to do evil. Labour after that holiness

Chapter 8



HOW TO CONTINUE IN THE SPIRIT-FILLED LIFE

When the Holy Spirit comes upon a person and he speaks in tongues for the first time, he is indeed filled with the Holy Spirit. However, some people continue to be filled with the Holy Spirit while others do not. Those who do not continue to be filled with the Holy Spirit may still continue to speak in tongues, but that does not say anything much. It is foolish to think that because a person was filled with the Holy Spirit once, he has necessarily continued to be filled. We can take an example from a drunkard. A man is filled with wine when he takes it to excess. As long as the wine fills him, he is drunk. If he continues to drink, he will remain drunk. If he stops drinking, the power of the wine will not be upon him and soon he will be like any other person.

The one who is filled with the Holy Spirit must continue to be filled with the Holy Spirit. He must receive fresh anointing from the Lord if he is not going to dry up.

That one must also ensure that the channels through which the Holy

Spirit flows are opened and enlarged so that He has liberty to flow in fuller measure.

BEING FILLED EVERY DAY

There is the command in the Scriptures to be filled with the Spirit (Ephesians 5:18). The command implies that anyone can be filled with the Holy Spirit after he has been baptized into the Holy Spirit, at any time that he wants. How can this be done? I suggest that each believer should be filled with the Holy Spirit in the morning of each day so that the day may be started in a Spirit-filled condition. The following instructions may help you:

1. Confess any sin that you have committed in thought, word or deed to the Lord.
2. Forsake that sin.
3. Consecrate yourself in totality to the Lord and His service.
4. Ask the Lord to fill you to overflowing with His Holy Spirit.
5. Receive the fullness of the Holy Spirit by faith.
6. Thank the Lord for filling you with the Holy Spirit.
7. Go out into the work to which the Lord has called you and serve Him with your whole heart.

I am told of a man of God who knelt by his bed and prayed to the Lord saying, "Lord, this bed is the altar, I am the lamb being sacrificed. I offer

myself to you completely without reserve to be your servant for the next twenty-four hours. Fill me now with your Holy Spirit, and keep me filled with the Holy Spirit for this period. Thank you, Lord, for hearing my prayer and filling me with the Holy Spirit. Amen.”

This man is said to have done this everyday of his life for forty years. During those years he walked in close fellowship with the Lord and bore abundant fruit. Because he co-operated with God, he was filled afresh with the Holy Spirit on a daily basis. A friend of mine who is a Director General began to receive a fresh infilling of the Holy Spirit from the Lord each morning after he finished having his quiet time with the Lord. He said that it made all the difference as to what happened at his office, whether or not he had received the infilling with the Holy Spirit for that day or not. Another man said that he was liberated from a long-standing tendency to impatience as he asked the Lord everyday to fill him afresh with the Holy Spirit.

Personally, I have decided that I will ask the Lord to fill me afresh with the Holy Spirit three times everyday. In the morning, I ask the Lord to fill me with the Holy Spirit.

Before doing so, I confess any sin in word, thought or action that I have committed. I receive the precious cleansing of the Lord. I then ask that the Lord should accept all that I am and all that I have for His service. Then I ask the Holy Spirit to come upon me and give me power to love the Lord and serve Him. I repeat the same process in the afternoon. I confess any careless word that I spoke. I confess any sinful or vain thought that lingered in my mind. I confess anything that was done or

said out of a selfish motive or because I was hurt. I ask the Holy Spirit to fill my life and I also ask Him to cause me to die increasingly to the “self” in me. In the evening, I do the same thing. I am not yet perfect, but from the time that I began to regularly receive the infilling with the Holy Spirit on a regular basis, and this is after I have been baptized into the Holy Spirit for fourteen years, everything in my life is changing. My relationship with my wife has been touched fundamentally. I am reacting differently to the pressures that come upon me everyday. I see more fruit in the ministry to God’s people and God’s world, and I give glory to the Lord Jesus for it all.

One thing which I do now which I did not do in the past is that when I sin, for example, if I expose the weakness of someone behind his back, or I am suspicious of someone’s motive for doing something, instead of just asking the Lord to forgive me and cleanse me, I ask him to forgive me and cleanse me and, in addition, I ask the Holy Spirit to fill me afresh. I have found that this makes the difference; for often I burst out speaking in tongues all over and all of a sudden the joy of the Lord just seizes me and I feel as if the Lord has cast me into His arms. I praise the Lord for His goodness to me in these ways.

GROWING IN THE SPIRIT-FILLED LIFE.

When a person is baptized into the Holy Spirit, he has the Holy Spirit in him like a river. If he goes the way of sin: the way of:

lying,

gossip,

anger,

pride,

laziness,

unforgiveness,

selfishness,

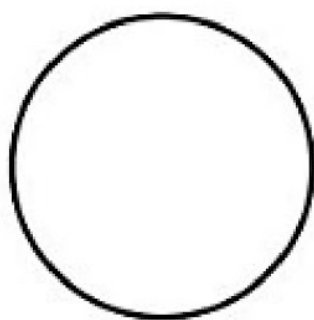
bitterness,

gluttony, etc.

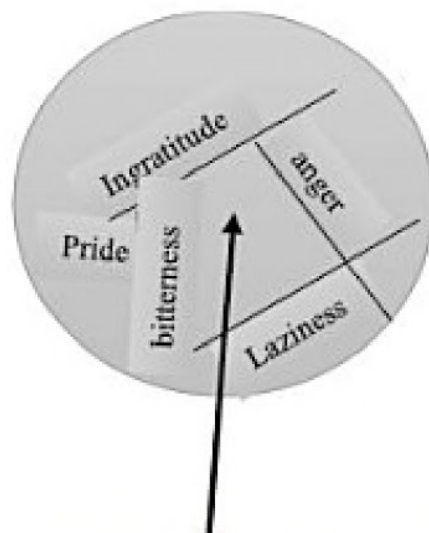
these sins will block the channel and reduce what is available for the river to flow through. As the person continues in sin without thoroughly confessing and forsaking each, things will become increasingly blocked until there is little room for the Spirit of God to flow through. He remains baptized into the Holy Spirit, but the flow of divine life and divine power is very severely restricted. Things can even get to a point where the available channel for the river is so limited that what actually gets through is less than the flow from a good spring. The person may continue to say that he is baptized into the Holy Spirit and speak in tongues, but his capacity to minister life and serve in power is even less than that of a person who received the Lord Jesus and has not yet been baptized into the Holy Spirit. Such people bring the doctrine of the baptism into the Holy Spirit into much disrepute.



The channel available in someone who has received God's life and the Holy Spirit is in him as a spring welling on to eternal life. He has some measure of spiritual power and can minister spiritual life to a fair extent.



The channel available in the person who has been baptized into the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit is in him a river flowing for abundant life and abundant ministry.



The channel available in a person who is baptized into the Holy Spirit but who allows sin to come into his life: vanity, lying, gossip, anger, pride, lust, laziness, etc. His effectiveness is less than that of the person who after receiving the Lord, and even though not baptized into the Holy Spirit, remains pure.

For a person to grow in the Spirit-filled life, he must do these things:

1. 1.He must ensure that sin does not settle in his life. He will therefore spend time before God and before God's word so that all sin is exposed, confessed and forsaken.
2. 2.He must get out of his life anything that is permitted but not helpful for the best in the Christian life. He will decide to get things increasingly out of his life. He will think less about being

happy, but more and more about being holy. The thought about:

- a. food
- b. houses
- c. wife/husband
- d. children
- e. nation
- f. career
- g. etc.

3. which though legitimate are not very helpful for the most spiritual progress will be got rid of so that the Holy Spirit has more room to move in freedom. The emptier a person is of things that pertain to this world, the more he makes room for the Holy Spirit to produce that which is other worldly. There is no other way out. If you want more things, you are also opting for less and less of the power of the Holy Spirit. More:

- a. cars
- b. houses
- c. clothes
- d. plots

- e. and the like;
- 4. occupy the mind and lead to worry, and there is therefore less time and place for the Spirit of God.
- 5. This truth is illustrated by how much material goods the Lord Jesus and the first apostles had for themselves!
- 6. 3. He must put into his life things that will provide the best co-operation with the Holy Spirit for Spiritual progress. He will put in the following increasingly:
 - a. Money given to the Lord's work and the poor.
 - b. Time spent in prayer (quality and quantity).
 - c. Time spent on the Word of the Lord (reading, memorizing and applying it).
 - d. Time and energy invested in serving others.
 - e. Time spent in ministering to:
 - i. the Lord
 - ii. the saints
 - iii. the lost.
 - iv. Suffering

v. Fasting

vi. and the others.

The more one puts in the right things, the more the channel will grow and the river will grow bigger and bigger.

operate with God after they were baptized into the Holy Spirit.

Because anyone who wants to can be born again and therefore have the Holy spirit in him as a spring welling up to eternal life, those who do not have the spring have only themselves to blame.

Because the baptism into the Holy Spirit is open to all believers with the accompanying river of living water, all who live as though the Holy Spirit had not been given have only themselves to blame. God has no favourites.

Because the possibility of further co-operation with God through prayer, fasting, giving to the Lord, Christian service, and the like is opened to all believers, any believer can expand the river in him to any extent that he wants. Therefore, a person is filled with the Holy Spirit to the extent that he wants. Those who have limited power have chosen that condition. Those who have more power have paid a price for it and you can have what you want. Jesus is available to all. Giving to the Lord, and the rest, is opened to all.

What will you do to expand your capacity for the Spirit-filled life?

Will you do something today?

Will you do something now?

God bless you!

Be filled now!

Are you filled at this moment?

Are you filled to maximum capacity?

Will you not open up to the more that God wants to give you?



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Zacharias Tanee Fomum

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VERY IMPORTANT!!!

If you have not yet received Jesus as your Lord and Saviour, I encourage you to receive Him. Here are some steps to help you,

ADMIT that you are a sinner by nature and by practice and that on your own you are without hope. Tell God you have personally sinned against Him in your thoughts, words and deeds. Confess your sins to Him, one after another in a sincere prayer. Do not leave out any sins that you can remember. Truly turn from your sinful ways and abandon them. If you stole, steal no more. If you have been committing adultery or fornication, stop it. God will not forgive you if you have no desire to stop sinning in all areas of your life, but if you are sincere, He will give you the power to stop sinning.

BELIEVE that Jesus Christ, who is God's Son, is the only Way, the only Truth and the only Life. Jesus said, "*I am the way, the truth and the*

into my heart now and give me eternal life right now. I will follow you at all costs, trusting the Holy Spirit to give me all the power I need.”

When you pray this prayer sincerely, Jesus answers at once and justifies you before God and makes you His child.

Please write to me (ztfbooks@cmfionline.org) and I will pray for you and help you as you go on with Jesus Christ.



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Zacharias Tanee FOMUM

1945-2009

Founding Leader,

[Christian Missionary Fellowship International](#)

(C.M.F.I)

Professor [Zacharias Tanee Fomum](#) was born in the flesh on 20th June 1945 and became born again on 13th June 1956. On 1st October 1966, He consecrated his life to the Lord Jesus and to His service, and was filled with the Holy Spirit on 24th October 1970. He was taken to be with the Lord on 14th March, 2009.

Pr Fomum was admitted to a first class in the Bachelor of Science degree, graduating as a prize winning student from Fourah Bay College in the University of Sierra Leone in October 1969. At the age of 28, he was awarded a Ph.D. in Organic Chemistry by the University of Makerere, Kampala in Uganda. In October 2005, he was awarded a Doctor of Science (D.Sc) by the University of Durham, Great Britain. This higher doctorate was in recognition of his distinct contributions to scientific knowledge through research. As a Professor of Organic Chemistry in the University of Yaounde 1, Cameroon, Professor Fomum supervised or co-supervised more than 100 Master's Degree and Doctoral Degree theses and co-authored over 160 scientific articles in leading international journals. He considered Jesus Christ the Lord of Science ("For by Him all things were created..." – Colossians 1:16), and scientific research an act of obedience to God's command to "subdue the earth" (Genesis 1:28). He therefore made the Lord Jesus the Director of his research laboratory while he took the place of deputy director, and attributed his outstanding success as a scientist to Jesus' revelational leadership.

In more than 40 years of Christian ministry, Pr Fomum travelled extensively, preaching the Gospel, planting churches and training spiritual leaders. He made more than:

- 700 missionary journeys within Cameroon, which ranged from one day to three weeks in duration.
- 500 missionary journeys to more than 70 different nations in all the six continents. These ranged from two days to six weeks in

duration.

By the time of his going to be with the Lord in 2009, he had preached in over 1000 localities in Cameroon, sent over 200 national missionaries into many localities in Cameroon and planted over 1300 churches in the various administrative provinces of Cameroon. At his base in Yaounde, he planted and built a mega-church with his co-workers which grew to a steady membership of about 12,000. Pr Fomum was the founding team-leader of Christian Missionary Fellowship International (CMFI); an evangelism, soul-winning, disciple making, Church-planting and missionary-sending movement with more than 200 international missionaries and thousands of churches in 65 nations spread across Africa, Europe, the Americas, Asia and Oceania. In the course of their ministry, Pr Fomum and his team witnessed more than 10,000 recorded healing miracles performed by God in answer to prayer in the name of Jesus Christ. These miracles include instant healings of headaches, cancers, HIV/AIDS, blindness, deafness, dumbness, paralysis, madness, and new teeth and organs received.

Pr Fomum read the entire Bible more than 60 times, read more than 1350 books on the Christian faith and authored over 150 books to advance the Gospel of Jesus Christ. 5 million copies of these books are in circulation in 12 languages as well as 16 million gospel tracts in 17 languages.

Pr Fomum was a man who sought God. He spent between 15 minutes and six hours daily alone with God in what he called Daily Dynamic Encounters with God (DDEWG). During these DDEWG he read God's Word, meditated on it, listened to God's voice, heard God speak to him,

Spiritual Warfare. He carried out over 250 fasts ranging from three days to forty days, drinking only water or water supplemented with soluble vitamins. Called by the Lord to a distinct ministry of intercession, he pioneered fasting and prayer movements and led in battles against principalities and powers obstructing the progress of the Gospel and God's global purposes. He was enabled to carry out 3 supra – long fasts of between 52 and 70 days in his final years.

Pr Fomum chose a lifestyle of simplicity and “self- imposed poverty” in order to invest more funds into the critical work of evangelism, soulwinning, church-planting and the building up of believers. Knowing the importance of money and its role in the battle to reach those without Christ with the glorious Gospel, he and his wife grew to investing 92.5% of their earned income from all sources (salaries, allowances, royalties and cash gifts) into the Gospel. They invested with the hope that, as they grew in the knowledge and the love of the Lord, and the perishing souls of people, they would one day invest 99% of their income into the Gospel.

He was married to Prisca Zei Fomum and they had seven children who are all involved in the work of the Gospel, some serving as missionaries. Prisca is a national and international minister, specializing in the winning and discipling of children to Jesus Christ. She also communicates and imparts the vision of ministry to children with a view to raising and building up ministers to them.

The Professor owed all that he was and all that God had done through him, to the unmerited favour and blessing of God and to his worldwide

army of friends and co-workers. He considered himself nothing without them and the blessing of God; and would have amounted to nothing but for them. All praise and glory to Jesus Christ!



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